

CLAT Express - March 2026: Practice Quizzes

MCQ: +1 for a correct answer, -0.25 for a wrong answer. TITA (type-in-the-answer): +1, no negative marking.

Multiple-choice passages

Iran-Israel Rivalry: Background

Relations between Iran and Israel have passed through sharply different phases. During the reign of Shah Mohammad Reza Pahlavi, the two countries were allies, and their ties continued for years. This changed with the 1979 revolution, when the Shah was ousted and an Islamic State was established in Iran. The new government broke all relations with Israel and treated it as an enemy. Ruhollah Khomeini, the religious leader behind the revolution, had earlier been a fierce critic of the Shah and had been forced out of Iran. From exile in Iraq, he continued to lead the revolutionary movement, and he developed a strongly anti-Western and anti-Israeli outlook.

The rivalry was not limited to diplomacy. Iran's Revolutionary Guard Corps built a wider network of armed groups across West Asia. The network was meant to confront Israel, the United States and other rival powers in the region. Its members included organisations in Lebanon, Gaza and Yemen. Each group had its own origin, leadership and political character, yet together they created pressure fronts against Israel. This proxy strategy became one of the main sources of tension in the region and remains central to understanding the present conflict.

Q1.

In which year did the Shah of Iran order Khomeini to leave Iran?

- (A) 1959
- (B) 1989
- (C) 1979
- (D) 1964

Q2.

Khomeini called America the 'Big Devil'. What did he call Israel?

- (A) Big Devil
- (B) Iron Devil
- (C) Little Shah
- (D) Little Devil

Q3.

The Houthi movement (Ansar Allah) emerged as an opposition movement in Yemen to fight which president?

- (A) Ali Abdullah Saleh
- (B) Ali Larijani
- (C) Mohammed Pakpour
- (D) Ismail Haniyeh

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Shah of Iran ordered Khomeini to leave Iran.

Reason (R): The Revolutionary Guard Corps created the Axis of Resistance to fight Israel and America.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Hamas	A. Sanaa
II. Hezbollah	B. Tehran
III. Ansar Allah	C. Beirut
IV. Golestan Palace	D. Gaza City

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Kharg Island handles nearly 90% of Iran's crude oil exports.
- II. The Ras Laffan LNG Complex is located in the UAE.
- III. Golestan Palace was inscribed as a World Heritage Site in 2013.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Shah ordered Khomeini to leave Iran in 1964.
- II. The Khomeini government broke all relations with Israel.
- III. Hamas is based in Lebanon.
- IV. Ansar Allah emerged in Iraq.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q8.

Which group had Ismail Haniyeh as its leader?

- (A) Hezbollah
- (B) Ansar Allah
- (C) Badr Organization
- (D) Hamas

Background of the open war

Pakistan and Afghanistan have shared a difficult relationship for decades, shaped by changes of government inside Afghanistan and by the border between the two countries. Afghanistan's monarchy ended in 1973 and was followed by a nationalist regime, then communist rule backed by the Soviet Union. Pakistan supported Afghan Mujahideen factions during the period of Soviet military intervention, and later became one of the few countries to recognise the Taliban regime. After the Taliban regained full control in 2021, Pakistan initially welcomed the development, expecting strategic alignment. Tensions soon resurfaced, however, as cross-border militancy

continued. Pakistan alleges that the Afghan Taliban is sheltering the TTP, while Afghan governments have historically disputed the legitimacy of the Durand Line, which Pakistan treats as a permanent international border. Afghanistan argues that the agreement behind the line was signed under colonial pressure, while Pakistan says it inherited the boundary after independence in 1947. Clashes at disputed checkpoints escalated into direct military confrontation, and the fighting drew a sharp response from India, which condemned Pakistan's attacks. Pakistan's traditional doctrine of strategic depth has also been eroded, since the Taliban has reached out to India and reduced Pakistan's leverage over Kabul. The result is a conflict in which border disputes, militancy and trade disruption reinforce one another.

Q1.

What is the name of the military operation Pakistan launched on Afghan military bases?

- (A) Operation Desert Shield
- (B) Operation Iron Fist
- (C) Operation Thunder Strike
- (D) Operation Ghazab-Lil-Haq

Q2.

Why was the Durand Line originally drawn in 1893?

- (A) To create a buffer zone to prevent Russian expansion toward British India during the Great Game
- (B) To separate Pashtun tribes from Arab influence
- (C) To define a trade route between India and Central Asia
- (D) To demarcate oil-rich territories between British India and Afghanistan

Q3.

Read the statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): The Taliban emerged in 1994 and captured Kabul in 1996.

Reason (R): The United States invaded Afghanistan after the 9/11 attacks and overthrew the Taliban.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Salma Dam	A. Symbol of India's commitment to Afghan democracy
II. Shahtoot Dam	B. Located in Herat Province
III. Zaranj-Delaram Highway	C. Drinking water supply for Kabul
IV. Afghan Parliament Building	D. Links Afghanistan to Iran's Chabahar Port

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the TAPI pipeline:

- I. It is a gas pipeline of 1814 km.
- II. It carries natural gas from the Galkynysh Gas Field in Turkmenistan.
- III. It was built as a water pipeline connecting Tajikistan to India.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the Zaranj-Delaram Highway are correct?

- I. It was built in 2009.
- II. It was constructed by India's Border Roads Organisation.
- III. It connects Afghanistan to China's Belt and Road Initiative.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) None
- (D) Only two

Q7.

Who was the Afghan ruler when the Durand Line was drawn?

- (A) Ahmad Shah Durrani
- (B) Amanullah Khan
- (C) Dost Mohammad Khan
- (D) Abdur Rahman Khan

Q8.

Consider the following statements about the Heart of Asia Process:

- I. It was an initiative of Turkey and Afghanistan.
- II. It started in 2011 to provide more assistance to Afghanistan.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) Both I and II
- (C) II only
- (D) Neither I nor II

Politics and Protests Check

Nepal has entered a new phase of politics after a landslide victory in its General Elections. The Rastriya Swatantra Party, led by Balendra Shah, who serves as Mayor of Kathmandu and is also a rapper, has reshaped the country's political map. The shift followed a period of deep anger among young citizens, who felt frustrated by corruption among political leaders, rising unemployment and a lack of accountability. Protests intensified, and the government led by KP Sharma Oli was forced out of power. Authorities responded by restricting online platforms, which left young people with fewer ways to voice their views. Security forces also used harsh measures against demonstrators, and this response further escalated public anger. The state's response to the unrest became a central part of the story. At 35, Balendra Shah is set to become Nepal's youngest Prime Minister. He is a leader of Madhesh descent, and his rise comes after a long history of political instability. Since the restoration of democracy in 1990, no government has completed a full term. The new leadership's approach to foreign policy will matter for neighbouring countries, especially India, which has long been a major partner of Nepal. The result signals a major political shift in the country's recent history.

Q1.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Bishweshwar Prasad Koirala	A. Rastriya Swatantra Party
II. KP Sharma Oli	B. CPN-Maoist Centre
III. Pushpa Kamal Dahal (Prachanda)	C. Nepali Congress
IV. Balendra Shah	D. CPN-UML

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q2.

In Nepal's federal democratic set-up, which office is the ceremonial head of state?

- (A) Prime Minister
- (B) Chief Justice
- (C) Speaker
- (D) President

Q3.

Which Indian paramilitary force has guarded Kalapani since 1962?

- (A) Indo-Tibetan Border Police
- (B) BSF
- (C) CRPF
- (D) Assam Rifles

Q4.

How many of the following statements about Nepal's political system are correct?

- I. The Constitution of Nepal was adopted in 2015.
- II. The President is the head of government.
- III. The House of Representatives has 275 members.
- IV. All 275 seats in the House are elected through FPTP.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) None

Q5.

Which 2025 movement toppled the government of KP Sharma Oli?

- (A) 1990 People's Movement
- (B) 2006 Jana Andolan II
- (C) Maoist Insurgency
- (D) Gen Z Protests

Q6.

The Madhesh region, called the 'Granary of Nepal', borders which Indian state?

- (A) Uttarakhand
- (B) Uttar Pradesh
- (C) Sikkim
- (D) Bihar

Q7.

Assertion (A): Nepal's 2025 protests were fuelled by the government's ban on social media platforms.

Reason (R): The ban cut off Gen Z's primary medium of expression.

Which one of the following is correct?

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q8.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Nepal shares a border of 1751 km with five Indian states.
- II. The 1950 Treaty of Peace and Friendship was signed by Nepal's PM Mohun Shumshere Rana and an Indian Ambassador.
- III. The Treaty of Sugauli (1816) was concluded between Nepal and the Mughal Empire.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Visit Outcomes Check

Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney visited India and signalled a reset in the relationship between the two countries. The reset came after a period of strained ties between the two countries. The visit led to a formal restart of negotiations on the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement, known as CEPA. Cooperation was also widened in several areas. In energy, a Canadian company agreed to supply uranium ore concentrates to India, which supports India's fuel security. On climate and energy, Canada announced its intention to join a major solar alliance. In technology, a trilateral partnership was launched to promote innovation across the three countries. In agriculture, a centre of excellence was set up to work on pulse-based food products. Student mobility was a key theme of the visit, as education links continue to grow. Students and research ties also received attention, with research internships planned for Indian students. Finally, a memorandum of understanding was signed to build secure supply chains in critical minerals. Bilateral trade is an important part of the relationship, and both sides want it to grow further. The outcomes cover trade, energy, technology, agriculture and people-to-people links. Taken together, these outcomes show how the two countries plan to move beyond trade into new areas of partnership.

Q1.

Which Canadian company is set to supply uranium ore concentrates to India?

- (A) Barrick Gold
- (B) Teck Resources
- (C) Suncor Energy
- (D) Cameco

Q2.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Diplomatic ties between India and Canada were established in 1947.
- II. India remains the largest source of international students to Canada.
- III. Canada's Cameco will supply uranium ore concentrates to India from 2025 to 2030.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q3.

From which year will Canada's Cameco begin supplying uranium ore concentrates to India?

- (A) 2025
- (B) 2026
- (C) 2028
- (D) 2027

Q4.

Assertion (A): The formal restart of CEPA talks was one of the outcomes of the Canadian PM's visit to India.

Reason (R): Diplomatic ties between India and Canada were established in 1947.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

At which institution was the India-Canada Pulse Protein Centre of Excellence established?

- (A) HT Delhi
- (B) ICAR - Indian Agricultural Research Institute
- (C) National Dairy Research Institute
- (D) National Institute of Food Technology Entrepreneurship and Management

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Pulse Protein Centre of Excellence	A. Alignment with G7 Critical Minerals Action Plan
II. Australia-Canada-India partnership	B. Upgrade to full membership
III. Global Biofuels Alliance	C. Emerging technologies, digital innovation and advanced manufacturing
IV. Critical minerals MoU	D. Fortified pulse products and food innovation

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

Q7.

What bilateral trade target has been set between India and Canada by 2030?

- (A) \$75 Billion
- (B) \$20 Billion
- (C) \$35 Billion
- (D) \$50 Billion

Q8.

How many of the following statements about the Australia-Canada-India Technology and Innovation Partnership are correct?

- I. It covers emerging technologies.
 - II. It focuses on space and defence.
 - III. It covers digital innovation and advanced manufacturing.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None of the above

Article 3 and renaming States

The Union Cabinet of India has approved a proposal to rename Kerala as Keralam. The change is being pursued under Article 3 of the Constitution. Article 3 empowers Parliament of India to reorganise States and provides a legal framework for altering India's political boundaries and State identities. Under this Article, Parliament can form a new State by separating territory from an existing State or by merging two or more States or parts of States. It can also increase the area of any State, diminish the area of any State, alter the boundaries of any State, and change the name of any State. Article 2 separately empowers Parliament to admit into the Union of India, or establish, new States on such terms and conditions as it thinks fit. The Constitution describes India as a Union, even though its structure is federal. Article 1 describes India, that is Bharat, as a Union of States rather than a Federation of States, and it deals with two matters: the name of the country and the type of polity. Articles 1 to 4 appear under Part I of the Constitution, which is titled Union and its Territory. The names of States and Union Territories, along with their territorial extent, are mentioned in the First Schedule of the Constitution. At present, India has 28 States and 8 Union Territories.

Q1.

Which authority's prior recommendation is mandatory before a Bill to rename a State can be introduced in Parliament?

- (A) The Governor of the State
- (B) The Supreme Court of India
- (C) The Election Commission of India
- (D) The President of India

Q2.

Assertion (A): Parliament can rename a State without a constitutional amendment.

Reason (R): Article 4 declares that laws made under Articles 2 and 3 are not amendments under Article 368.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Mysore	A. Odisha
II. Madras	B. Uttarakhand
III. Orissa	C. Karnataka
IV. Uttaranchal	D. Tamil Nadu

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Article 2 empowers Parliament to admit into the Union of India or establish new States.
- II. Admission under Article 2 refers to establishment of States which were not in existence before.
- III. Article 4 treats laws made under Articles 2 and 3 as amendments under Article 368.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about the integration of Princely States are correct?

- I. Hyderabad was integrated into India by police action.
- II. Junagarh was integrated into India by means of a referendum.
- III. Kashmir was integrated into India by a treaty of merger.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q6.

After becoming a Protectorate of India in 1950, Sikkim was formally recognised as a State of the Indian Union in which year?

- (A) 1950
- (B) 1953
- (C) 1956
- (D) 1975

Q7.

The Fazl Ali Commission suggested creating which combination of States and Centrally Administered Territories?

- (A) 14 States and 6 Union Territories
- (B) 16 States and 6 Union Territories
- (C) 9 States and 3 Union Territories
- (D) 16 States and 3 Centrally Administered Territories

Creamy layer ruling: MCQ set

In March 2026, the Supreme Court of India ruled that parental income alone cannot be the sole criterion for determining the creamy layer status of Other Backward Classes (OBCs). The

judgement responds to a concern about consistency in how the creamy layer is determined. The Court pointed to an uneven system in which children of government employees are assessed on the basis of parental rank or post, while children of employees in public sector undertakings and the private sector are assessed mainly on parental income. It described this unequal method as inconsistent and in conflict with the principle of equality.

Commentary on the ruling holds that rank or position in employment reflects social status and influence better than income alone. Commentary on the ruling also notes that long years of service may raise salary levels without necessarily improving social standing, especially for lower-level employees. A post-based criterion applied across all sectors could, in this commentary's view, provide a fair and consistent way to identify the creamy layer.

The ruling has drawn criticism. Private-sector employers have no standardised rank hierarchy, which makes post-based classification difficult. Critics also argue that income strongly shapes access to quality education and opportunities, and that high-income families in the private sector could keep reservation benefits, limiting opportunities for economically weaker OBC groups.

Q1.

A family is treated as creamy layer if its annual income exceeds what amount, and for how many consecutive years?

- (A) 5 lakh for 3 consecutive years
- (B) 6 lakh for 3 consecutive years
- (C) 8 lakh for 3 consecutive years
- (D) 10 lakh for 2 consecutive years

Q2.

Which 2018 judgement held that creamy layer exclusion extends to SCs and STs?

- (A) IR Coelho case
- (B) Nagaraj case
- (C) Janhit Abhiyan case
- (D) Jarnail Singh vs Lachhmi Narain Gupta case

Q3.

In the Champakam Dorairajan vs State of Madras (1951) case, what did the Court rule?

- (A) Caste-based reservations are valid under Article 15
- (B) Economic criteria must be used for reservation
- (C) Reservation cannot exceed 27%
- (D) Caste-based reservations are in violation of Article 15

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Supreme Court in the Nagaraj case (2006) held that the State was not bound to provide reservation in promotions to SCs and STs.

Reason (R): Tamil Nadu's 69% reservation policy was placed under the 9th Schedule in 1994.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Kalelkar Commission	A. State not bound to provide reservation in promotions
II. Mandal (second Backward Classes) Commission	B. Identified backward classes other than SCs and STs at national level
III. Nagaraj case (2006)	C. Upheld the 103rd Constitutional Amendment (EWS)
IV. Janhit Abhiyan case (2022)	D. Identified 3,743 castes

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Indra Sawhney judgement (1992):

- I. Reservation in promotions was permitted for OBCs.
- II. The Creamy Layer was introduced and must be excluded while identifying Backward Classes.
- III. Total reservation could exceed 50% in special cases.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the Indra Sawhney judgement (1992):

- I. It upheld 27% reservation for OBCs with conditions.
- II. It upheld the additional 10% reservation for poorer sections of higher castes.
- III. It introduced the concept of Creamy Layer.
- IV. It upheld the carry forward rule for unfilled vacancies.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only four
- (D) Only three

Q8.

In which Schedule of the Constitution was Tamil Nadu's 69% reservation policy placed in 1994?

- (A) 7th Schedule
- (B) 11th Schedule
- (C) 12th Schedule
- (D) 9th Schedule

Amendment Bill: direct and reasoning check

The Union Government presented the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Amendment Bill, 2026 in the Lok Sabha. The Bill proposes to revise the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019, which was enacted after the Supreme Court's judgment in NALSA vs Union of India had granted legal recognition and rights to transgender persons. The Bill changes several parts of the 2019 framework. It revisits how the term transgender person is defined, how a transgender

identity is verified and certified, what medical institutions must do in certain cases, how the National Council for Transgender Persons is constituted, and which penalties apply to certain offences. Supporters present these changes as a way to target welfare more precisely and to make certification more structured. Critics respond that some changes conflict with principles laid down in the NALSA judgment and raise concerns about medical scrutiny, privacy and the possible misuse of broadly worded terms. Understanding the debate therefore requires looking at how the new provisions relate to earlier rulings on identity, dignity and privacy. The wider history of these rights in India involves courts, Parliament and the executive, each shaping the rules that apply to the people concerned. Because the terminology in this area varies with historical, cultural and social contexts, the way a law defines its categories matters a great deal in practice.

Q1.

Under the Bill, who issues the transgender identity certificate based on the Medical Board's recommendation?

- (A) Chief Medical Officer
- (B) State Health Minister
- (C) District Magistrate
- (D) High Court Judge

Q2.

Assertion (A): Under the Bill, individuals who undergo gender reassignment surgery must apply for a revised gender certificate.

Reason (R): Under the Bill, medical institutions must report gender-affirming surgeries to the District Magistrate.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Life imprisonment	A. Forcing children into begging
II. Up to 14 years imprisonment	B. Nominated members of the National Council
III. Director rank or above	C. Change of name in official documents
IV. Certificate holders	D. Forced mutilation of minors

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the Amendment Bill:

- I. The Bill omits Section 4(2) of the 2019 Act.
- II. A Medical Board led by a Chief Medical Officer or Deputy CMO verifies transgender identity under the Bill.
- III. The National Council will have no representatives from States or Union Territories.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Consider the following provisions of the Amendment Bill:

- I. Life imprisonment for forced mutilation of minors.
- II. Up to 14 years imprisonment for forcing children into begging.
- III. Mandatory reporting of gender-affirming surgeries to the District Magistrate.
- IV. Dissolution of the National Council for Transgender Persons.

How many of the above are provisions of the Bill, as described in the booklet?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Q6.

According to the booklet, what does the requirement for medical institutions to report gender-affirming surgeries enable?

- (A) Enforcement of decriminalisation of same-sex relationships
- (B) Discretionary power for District Magistrates over surgeries
- (C) Prevention of changes to first names in documents
- (D) A national database for healthcare planning and welfare

Q7.

In the *Supriyo vs Union of India* (2023) case, what did the five-judge Constitution Bench do?

- (A) Legalised same-sex marriage in India
- (B) Recognised privacy as a fundamental right
- (C) Struck down Section 377
- (D) Rejected petitions to legalise same-sex marriage

Revised GDP Series Practice

Measuring an economy requires a fixed reference period against which later figures are compared. This reference, known as the base year, is used to calculate price-adjusted output, so that changes in the size of an economy are not confused with changes in prices. As economies evolve, a base year that once reflected the production structure gradually becomes outdated. New industries grow, consumer habits shift, and the relative importance of sectors changes. Statisticians therefore revise the base year at intervals, rebuilding national accounts on a newer structure. Each revision also gives an opportunity to improve methods and draw on fresh information. Administrative records, periodic household surveys and financial data can capture activities that older estimates may have missed, such as small unregistered enterprises and digital services. The methods used to remove price effects from output figures can also be refined, which sharpens the estimate of value added in key sectors. International guidelines for national accounts are updated periodically, and revisions help countries keep their figures comparable with global standards. Because gross domestic product guides budget planning, investment decisions and assessments of fiscal health, a revision can change reported growth rates and ratios even when the real economy has not changed.

Q1.

The 2026 revision marks which base year revision since 1948-49?

- (A) Fifth
- (B) Sixth
- (C) Eighth
- (D) Tenth

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Single deflation	A. Adjusts both output and input prices
II. Double deflation	B. Total monetary value of all finished goods and services produced
III. Base year 2022-23	C. Adjusts only output prices
IV. Gross Domestic Product	D. Most recent normal economic year after COVID-19 disruptions

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q3.

Which survey, newly used as a data source in the revised GDP series, covers unincorporated sector enterprises?

- (A) Annual Survey of Industries
- (B) Consumer Expenditure Survey
- (C) National Sample Survey
- (D) Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises

Q4.

Which two pension systems are now included in GDP government sector accounting under the revised series?

- (A) National Pension System and Old Pension Scheme
- (B) Atal Pension Yojana and PM-SYM
- (C) Employee Provident Fund and Gratuity
- (D) PM Jan Dhan Yojana and PM Jeevan Jyoti Bima

Q5.

How many of the following statements about the revised GDP series are correct?

- I. It aligns with System of National Accounts 2008 and the IMF Quarterly National Accounts Manual 2017.
 - II. It captures platform workers and hired domestic workers.
 - III. It was released by the Ministry of Finance.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the revised GDP series:

- I. The new base year 2022-23 replaces 2011-12 as the benchmark.
- II. Government sector accounts now include the National Pension System and the Old Pension Scheme.
- III. Double deflation ignores input prices when measuring real value addition.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Who led the National Income Committee that compiled India's first National Income Estimates in 1949?

- (A) C.D. Deshmukh
- (B) B.R. Ambedkar
- (C) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (D) PC Mahalanobis

Q8.

Assertion (A): The 2026 revision raised the nominal GDP estimate for FY 2025-26.

Reason (R): A base year removes the inflation effect and enables accurate index creation.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

World Happiness Report: CLAT practice

Happiness is increasingly discussed as a measure of progress, not only as a private feeling. Every year, a global report asks people to rate their own lives on a scale from zero to ten and compares the results across countries. Governments and researchers use these results to judge development beyond the size of an economy. The report considers several factors, including income, social support, health, freedom, generosity and perceptions of corruption, which together help explain differences in how people feel about their lives.

Digital life has become a major area of study in recent editions. Researchers ask whether time spent on social media affects young people, and whether internet access brings benefits that outweigh its risks. The findings are mixed. Connectivity can support learning and communication, yet heavy use may be linked with stress and anxiety. Patterns also vary by age, so the experience of teenagers can differ sharply from that of older adults.

The wider theme is well-being as a policy goal. Supporters argue that a country's progress should be judged partly by the lives its people lead, and not only by how much they produce. Annual observances, held in March, also draw attention to this idea and to the value of social trust and good governance.

Q1.

Assertion (A): Finland was the top-ranked country in the World Happiness Report 2026.

Reason (R): Finland's rank in the 2026 report was fourth.

Which of the following is correct?

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Afghanistan	A. Rose from 23rd to 4th
II. Costa Rica	B. Lowest ranked at 147th
III. India	C. Top-ranked BRICS nation
IV. China	D. Rank 116th

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q3.

Consider the following statements about youth and social media use in the 2026 report:

- I. Youth using social media for under one hour a day reported better well-being than non-users.
- II. Youth aged 15-24 reported higher life satisfaction than those aged 60 and above.
- III. Adolescent girls using social media for more than five hours a day were identified as the most vulnerable group.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q4.

What was India's happiness score in the 2026 report?

- (A) 4.536
- (B) 3.982
- (C) 4.921
- (D) 5.103

Q5.

Which edition of the World Happiness Report was released in 2026?

- (A) 10th
- (B) 12th
- (C) 14th
- (D) 16th

Q6.

Which organisation published the World Happiness Report 2026?

- (A) United Nations Development Programme
- (B) World Health Organization
- (C) World Economic Forum
- (D) Oxford Wellbeing Research Centre

Q7.

What is the theme of the International Day of Happiness 2026?

- (A) Health and Harmony
- (B) Peace and Prosperity
- (C) Care and Share
- (D) Hope and Happiness

Global arms transfers quiz

International arms transfers are the movement of weapons and military equipment from one country to another, and they show how global defence trade is changing. The Stockholm International Peace Research Institute, an independent research body that studies conflict and peace, armaments, military expenditure and disarmament, examined these transfers in its Trends in International Arms Transfers 2025 report. The report analysed the period from 2021 to 2025 and compared it with the earlier five-year period from 2016 to 2020, which allows changes in global defence trade to be measured over time. Its findings show that overall transfers grew between the two periods. The increase was particularly strong in Europe, where arms imports rose sharply, and the institute linked much of this surge to the Russia-Ukraine war. Trade patterns also shifted among suppliers, as one major exporter saw its shipments fall significantly and its share of global exports became much smaller. The report offers a picture of which countries supply weapons to the world and which countries buy them. Such information helps observers understand how the balance of global defence trade is moving. Because the report looks at both exporting and importing countries, it gives a balanced view of the market, showing which states sell arms abroad and which states acquire them for their own forces. The analysis also places the transfers within the institute's wider focus on armaments and military expenditure.

Q1.

Which of the following statements about the SIPRI report are correct?

- I. The United States was the top arms exporter in 2021-25 with a 42% share.
- II. Russia's arms exports declined by 64%, reducing its share of global exports to 6.8%.
- III. Germany was the second-largest arms exporter in the world.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Share of the United States in global arms exports	A. 9.2%
II. Rise in European arms imports	B. 42%
III. Russia's share of global arms exports	C. 210%
IV. Rise in international arms transfers, 2021-25	D. 6.8%

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q3.

By what percentage did international arms transfers increase in 2021-25 compared with 2016-20?

- (A) 5.4%
- (B) 7.8%
- (C) 9.2%
- (D) 12.6%

Q4.

Which country was the largest supplier of India's arms imports during 2021-25?

- (A) France
- (B) Israel
- (C) Russia
- (D) Armenia

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the SIPRI report.

- I. SIPRI was established in 1966 and is headquartered in Stockholm, Sweden.
- II. Ukraine was the top arms exporter in the 2021-25 period.
- III. India's overall arms imports declined by 4% in 2021-25.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q6.

Which country was the top arms importer globally in 2021-25, with a 9.7% share?

- (A) Ukraine
- (B) India
- (C) Qatar
- (D) Pakistan

Q7.

Assertion (A): India's overall arms imports declined during 2021-2025.

Reason (R): India's share of global arms imports was the highest in the world during 2021-2025.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Milano Cortina 2026 MCQ practice

The 25th Winter Olympic Games were held from 6 to 22 February 2026 in Italy. The Games were hosted by two cities, Milan and Cortina d'Ampezzo, and the booklet describes them as the first joint two-city Winter Olympics. This was the fourth time that Italy hosted an Olympic Games. Italy had earlier hosted the Winter Games at Cortina in 1956, the Summer Games at Rome in 1960 and the Winter Games at Turin in 2006. The Opening Ceremony took place at the San Siro Stadium in Milan, while the Closing Ceremony was held at the Verona Arena. The official motto of the Games was 'IT's Your Vibe', and the mascots were Tina and Milo, two white stoats. The Games were given the theme 'Armonia', meaning Harmony. The Olympic Games are governed by the International Olympic Committee, which has its headquarters in Lausanne, Switzerland. The Winter Games in Italy therefore combined two cities, a long Olympic history and a clear set of official symbols. The modern Olympic Games were founded by Baron Pierre de Coubertin. The first modern Olympic event was held at Athens in 1896, after King George I of Greece officially announced the start of the Games. The ancient Olympic Games began in 776 BCE in Olympia, Greece.

Q1.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Norway	A. 30 medals
II. USA	B. 20 medals
III. Netherlands	C. 33 medals
IV. Italy	D. 41 medals

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q2.

Which sport made its debut at the 2026 Winter Olympics?

- (A) Ski Mountaineering (Skimo)
- (B) Freestyle Skiing
- (C) Short Track Speed Skating
- (D) Snowboard Cross

Q3.

How many winter sports were featured at the 2026 Winter Olympics?

- (A) 12
- (B) 14
- (C) 18
- (D) 16

Q4.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The 2022 Winter Games were held in Beijing, China.
- II. The first Winter Olympic Games were held in 1924 in Chamonix, France.
- III. India sent 6 athletes to the 2026 Winter Olympics.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q5.

Assertion (A): India sent two athletes to the 2026 Winter Olympics.

Reason (R): India's Winter Olympics contingent won no medals.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Where will the 2030 Winter Games be held?

- (A) Verona, Italy
- (B) Beijing, China
- (C) French Alps
- (D) Lausanne, Switzerland

Q7.

Which country topped the final medal table at the 2026 Winter Olympics?

- (A) USA
- (B) Netherlands
- (C) Norway
- (D) Italy

Q8.

- I. Italy won 30 medals at the 2026 Winter Olympics, including 10 gold medals.
- II. Norway topped the final medal table for the fourth consecutive time.
- III. Neeraj Chopra was India's torchbearer at the 2026 Winter Olympics.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Global burden and progress check

World Tuberculosis Day is observed every year to raise awareness about a disease that is spread through the air and is both preventable and curable. The day also seeks to accelerate global efforts to eliminate the disease, and this year's message stresses that countries lead the response while people power it. The disease has been known to science for more than a century, yet it continues to affect people around the world. Public health bodies monitor the disease through a few core measures. Incidence is measured as a rate per 100,000 people. Deaths are tracked as a separate measure. The latest global report reviews the situation for recent years. It looks at how the caseload is spread across countries and regions, and it identifies where most of the burden sits. Concentration matters because a small group of countries often carries most of the caseload. Targeted action in those places therefore matters a great deal for global totals. Officials regularly compare countries, track trends and review progress, so that resources reach the places where they are needed most.

Q1.

According to the Global TB Report 2025, which country has the highest share of the world's TB cases?

- (A) Indonesia
- (B) Philippines
- (C) India
- (D) Brazil

Q2.

What share of the world's TB cases in 2024 were concentrated in 30 high-burden countries?

- (A) 87%
- (B) 65%
- (C) 75%
- (D) 92%

Q3.

By what percentage did global TB deaths decline over the 2015 to 2024 period?

- (A) 12%
- (B) 21%
- (C) 67%
- (D) 29%

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. TB Mukht Bharat App	A. 100 Days Intensified Campaign
II. TB Mukht Bharat Abhiyaan	B. Digital platform for monitoring, awareness and citizen participation
III. TB Mukht Urban Ward Initiative	C. Monthly nutritional support by direct benefit transfer
IV. Ni-Kshay Poshan Yojana	D. Urban TB hotspots and localised intervention

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q5.

Consider the following statements about tuberculosis:

- I. Pulmonary TB affects the lungs and is highly contagious.
- II. Extrapulmonary TB is the most contagious form of the disease.
- III. TB is preventable and curable with timely diagnosis and appropriate treatment.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the TB figures given in the booklet:

- I. 87% of 2024 cases were concentrated in 30 high-burden countries.
- II. Global TB deaths declined by 12% over 2015 to 2024.
- III. India accounts for 25% of global TB cases.
- IV. Eight nations drive 87% of global TB cases.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q7.

What was India's TB incidence rate per 100,000 population in 2024?

- (A) 131
- (B) 195
- (C) 150
- (D) 187

Constitution and governance: MCQ practice

Constitutional and legal institutions have been in the news, with several debates on how officials and courts are protected and held accountable. Opposition parties have moved to remove the sitting Chief Election Commissioner, a process set out in the Constitution that can be started in either House of Parliament. The Commissioner's position is protected by a procedure that mirrors the one used for judges of the Supreme Court. Elsewhere, the courts have been shaping end-of-life decisions. The Supreme Court has allowed the withdrawal of life support for a patient who had

remained in a vegetative state for many years, applying a framework that recognises living wills and requires medical board evaluation. The judiciary also guards its own authority through the law of contempt, which covers both civil and criminal contempt and treats acts that scandalise the court as offences. In the digital sphere, the government has been reviewing how online content is blocked, while the Karnataka government has proposed restricting social media use by children. Together, these developments show how the state, the courts and the legislature continue to balance individual rights with institutional authority. Each debate raises the question of whether the existing safeguards are strong enough to protect constitutional office holders and to ensure that legal processes remain transparent, timely and open to oversight.

Q1.

Read the statements.

Assertion (A): The Supreme Court in 2018 legalised passive euthanasia in India under regulated conditions.

Reason (R): The Supreme Court held that the right to die with dignity forms part of Article 21.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q2.

Under which Article of the Constitution is the procedure for removing the Chief Election Commissioner laid down?

- (A) Article 129
- (B) Article 215
- (C) Article 324(5)
- (D) Article 21

Q3.

Which Article declares every High Court in India a Court of Record?

- (A) Article 19(1)(a)
- (B) Article 129
- (C) Article 21
- (D) Article 215

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Support needed in Lok Sabha to introduce a CEC removal motion	A. 50 members
II. Support needed in Rajya Sabha to introduce a CEC removal motion	B. Three members
III. Members of the inquiry committee	C. Motion does not lapse
IV. Effect of prorogation on a removal motion	D. 100 members

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q5.

Under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, violations of its child-protection provisions may attract penalties up to what amount?

- (A) 50 crore
- (B) 250 crore
- (C) 200 crore
- (D) 10 crore

Q6.

How many Lok Sabha members must support a motion to remove the Chief Election Commissioner for the motion to be introduced?

- (A) 100
- (B) 50
- (C) 150
- (D) 200

Q7.

Consider the following statements about euthanasia in India:

- I. Active euthanasia, through a deliberate lethal intervention, is legally permitted.
- II. Passive euthanasia may involve withdrawing ventilators or artificial nutrition.
- III. The 2023 modification introduced timelines for medical board decisions.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q8.

Consider the following statements about the removal of the Chief Election Commissioner:

- I. The motion can be introduced in either House of Parliament.
- II. The motion lapses automatically if Parliament is prorogued.
- III. Other Election Commissioners are removed by Parliament on a special majority.
- IV. The Speaker or the Chairman examines the motion before admission.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Oscars Quick Check

The Academy Awards, popularly known as the Oscars, are among the best-known honours in the film industry. The 98th edition of the awards was held in Los Angeles to celebrate excellence in global cinema. The awards recognise artistic and technical achievements, and they cover a wide range of work, including acting, directing and writing. They are presented by the Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences, an organisation based in the United States. The annual ceremony takes place at the Dolby Theatre in Los Angeles. Over the years the awards have grown in scope, and the categories have expanded from 12 to 24. Because the awards cover technical as well as artistic work, they recognise many of the people who contribute to a film. Keeping these basic details in mind helps a candidate answer questions on the Oscars with confidence.

Q1.

Which film was the first Best Picture winner at the Academy Awards?

- (A) Wings
- (B) Mother India
- (C) Flow
- (D) RRR

Q2.

How many Best Actress awards does Katharine Hepburn hold, according to the booklet?

- (A) 2
- (B) 3
- (C) 5
- (D) 4

Q3.

Who conceptualised the Oscars?

- (A) Walt Disney
- (B) Sean Baker
- (C) Paul Thomas Anderson
- (D) Louis B. Mayer

Q4.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- I. The Oscars were conceptualised by Louis B. Mayer, co-founder of MGM Studios.
- II. The Oscar statuette depicts a knight standing on a reel of film holding a sword.
- III. The Oscar statuette is made of solid gold.

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about the 98th Academy Awards are correct?

- I. One Battle After Another won Best Picture.
- II. Paul Thomas Anderson won Best Director.
- III. Hamnet won Best Picture.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Record for most Oscars	A. Paul Thomas Anderson
II. Leads in Best Actress wins	B. Wings
III. First Best Picture winner	C. Walt Disney
IV. Best Director, 98th Academy Awards	D. Katharine Hepburn

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q7.

Which person holds the record for the most Oscars, with 22?

- (A) Katharine Hepburn
- (B) Sean Baker
- (C) Walt Disney
- (D) Paul Thomas Anderson

Q8.

Assertion (A): The number of Oscar categories has increased over time.

Reason (R): The awards started with 12 categories and have since expanded to 24.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

International Bodies MCQ Set

Several international bodies were in the news in March 2026, and their work shows how countries cooperate across borders. Argentina has decided to leave the World Health Organization, a specialised agency of the United Nations, after giving the required notice period. The move was linked to concerns about sovereignty and dissatisfaction with the organisation's response to COVID-19. The WHO remains responsible for global public health governance, and India falls under its South-East Asia Regional Office. India also has a role in gender equality forums. Its Women and Child Development Minister is to represent the country at the 70th Session of the Commission on the Status of Women in New York, and India has been re-elected to the Commission. The Commission is the principal intergovernmental body of the United Nations dedicated to gender equality and women's empowerment. In the Bay of Bengal region, India hosted a youth programme under BIMSTEC, a grouping that aims to promote cooperation in trade, connectivity, energy and sustainable development. The programme was organised by the Ministry of External Affairs and Bharat Scouts, and it aimed to boost youth engagement and regional cooperation. In Europe, India and Croatia discussed trade and investment opportunities during talks with the Special Envoy for the Three Seas Initiative, a regional platform of European Union countries located between three major seas. Together, these developments show how governments use global and regional forums to pursue shared goals.

Q1.

Which city is the headquarters of the World Health Organization?

- (A) New Delhi
- (B) New York
- (C) Geneva
- (D) Jamnagar

Q2.

How many member States does the Commission on the Status of Women have?

- (A) 45
- (B) 13
- (C) 192
- (D) 7

Q3.

Assertion (A): The World Health Organization came into force on 7 April 1948.

Reason (R): The WHO has its headquarters in Geneva, Switzerland.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) A is false but R is true
- (D) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

Q4.

- I. The Three Seas Initiative is a regional cooperation platform of 13 European Union countries.
- II. The Black Sea is a branch of the North Atlantic Ocean.
- III. The World Health Organization functions through six regional offices.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. BIMSTEC	A. Established in 1946
II. Three Seas Initiative	B. Established in 1997 (Bangkok Declaration)
III. Commission on the Status of Women	C. Came into force on 7 April 1948
IV. World Health Organization	D. Initiated in 2016 by Poland and Croatia

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

- I. The WHO has 192 member States.
- II. The Commission on the Status of Women is placed under the UN Security Council.
- III. Argentina's exit from the WHO took effect as soon as it was announced.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) None
- (D) Only three

Q7.

Which body provides secretariat support to the Commission on the Status of Women?

- (A) UNDP
- (B) UNICEF
- (C) World Health Organization
- (D) UN Women

Q8.

Under the Most Favoured Nation principle, if a country gives lower tariffs to one WTO member, what must it do?

- (A) Apply it only to EU members
- (B) Withdraw it after five years
- (C) Extend the same to all WTO members
- (D) Give it only to developing countries

Geneva Talks and the Strikes

Diplomacy over Iran's nuclear programme had been a central source of tension in West Asia for years. Talks held in Geneva collapsed after the United States insisted that Iran take apart some of its main nuclear sites and stop enriching uranium altogether. The breakdown came against a longer history. A 2015 agreement between Iran and a group of major powers had limited Iran's

enrichment in return for sanctions relief. The United States later walked away from that deal and reinstated sanctions, and Iran began to breach the limits it had accepted.

Tensions were also fuelled by concerns over the regional balance of power. Iran's effort to build a land corridor through Iraq, Syria and Lebanon alarmed Washington and its partners, while Iran's support for armed groups in several countries created pressure fronts against Israel.

When diplomacy failed, the United States and Israel launched joint strikes on Iran. The offensive relied on heavy bombers and targeted fortified installations, including nuclear infrastructure. Iran responded with missiles and drones aimed at Israeli and American military targets, and the retaliatory attacks reached several Gulf states. The escalation was the latest step in a long rivalry over influence in West Asia, and it raised fears of a wider conflict across the region.

Q1.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Operation Epic Fury was the name of the US operation against Iran.
- II. The Sejil is a three-stage missile.
- III. Kharg Island lies about 50 km off Iran's coast in the Persian Gulf.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q2.

Assertion (A): The Sejil missile is called the 'Dancing Missile'.

Reason (R): The Sejil is noted for high-altitude manoeuvrability.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

What share of Iran's crude oil exports does Kharg Island handle?

- (A) About 50%
- (B) About 65%
- (C) Nearly 90%
- (D) Nearly 100%

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Kharg Island	A. Nicknamed 'Bone'
II. Sejil missile	B. Heavily protected nuclear research centre near which Iranian missiles struck
III. B-1B Lancer	C. Two-stage solid-fuel medium-range ballistic missile
IV. Dimona	D. Handles nearly 90% of Iran's crude oil exports

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Q5.

Talks in Geneva collapsed over US demands that Iran dismantle which two nuclear facilities?

- (A) Fordow and Natanz
- (B) Isfahan and Arak
- (C) Bushehr and Parchin
- (D) Qom and Saghand

Q6.

Which aircraft used bunker-buster bombs to strike the fortified Fordow facility?

- (A) B-1B Lancer
- (B) Iron Dome
- (C) Sejil
- (D) B-2 bombers

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The JCPOA was signed in 2015 between Iran and the P5+1 group of countries.
- II. The US withdrew from the JCPOA in 2015.
- III. Iranian missiles struck near the Dimona nuclear research centre.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) II and III only

Office of the Supreme Leader

Iran's political system is built around the office of Supreme Leader, which holds ultimate authority over the country's political, military and religious institutions. The office is the country's head of state in law and oversees national security and foreign policy. Its holder also has a strong say over who may stand in elections, through the vetting process.

The office rests on an idea that a senior Islamic jurist should exercise ultimate political authority in an Islamic state, combining religious legitimacy with political governance. The idea was given an institutional form after the 1979 revolution, when the first holder of the office took power.

The leader is chosen by a clerical body that is itself elected by the public. This body also monitors how the leader performs his duties. A 1989 constitutional amendment reshaped the rules for selecting the office's holder, and the office has recently passed to a new holder after the death of its previous occupant.

Q1.

Which body elects Iran's Supreme Leader?

- (A) Iranian Parliament (Majlis)
- (B) Guardian Council
- (C) Assembly of Experts
- (D) Revolutionary Guards Council

Q2.

A 1989 constitutional amendment relaxed which earlier requirement for the Supreme Leader?

- (A) Being a Marja, the highest-ranking Shia clerical authority
- (B) Holding a seat in the Majlis
- (C) Serving as a military commander
- (D) Being elected by the public directly

Q3.

Who was Iran's first Supreme Leader after the revolution?

- (A) Ali Khamenei
- (B) Mojtaba Khamenei
- (C) Hassan Rouhani
- (D) Ruhollah Khomeini

Q4.

Along with its role as head of state, which military role does Iran's Supreme Leader hold?

- (A) Chief of Army Staff
- (B) Defence Minister
- (C) Commander-in-chief of the armed forces
- (D) Speaker of the Majlis

Q5.

Assertion (A): The Assembly of Experts can remove the Supreme Leader from office.

Reason (R): The Assembly monitors the Supreme Leader's qualifications and performance.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Mojtaba Khamenei was named the third Supreme Leader after Ali Khamenei's assassination.
- II. The 1989 amendment made the Supreme Leader's office hereditary.
- III. The Supreme Leader's authority derives from Velayat-e Faqih.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) II and III only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Supreme Leader is chosen by the Assembly of Experts.
- II. The Supreme Leader has no role in national security.
- III. The Assembly of Experts has 88 members.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

India's Energy Exposure

India depends heavily on imported energy, and much of its supply moves through the Strait of Hormuz, the passage that connects the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman. Because a large share of India's crude oil imports and a significant portion of its gas imports use this route, tensions in the region are felt quickly across the Indian economy.

Global crude oil prices have climbed sharply during the crisis, which raises the cost of India's import bill. Higher costs then feed into transport, fertiliser, manufacturing and logistics, adding pressure on inflation and on the government's finances, since it may absorb part of the price shock through tax cuts.

To cushion such shocks, India maintains a strategic petroleum reserve, meant to act as a buffer

against global oil shocks and to help stabilise prices. Reserves of this kind are meant to ensure that industry and defence receive uninterrupted fuel during supply disruptions, and to reduce dependence on external suppliers. Many governments hold reserves covering a set period of net oil imports, and India's programme is part of its response to the current instability in West Asia.

Q1.

What is the global norm for net oil import reserves that countries generally aim to maintain?

- (A) 30 days
- (B) 60 days
- (C) 90 days
- (D) 120 days

Q2.

Which new Strategic Petroleum Reserve site is located in Odisha?

- (A) Chandikhol
- (B) Padur
- (C) Bikaner
- (D) Rajkot

Q3.

Which body manages India's Strategic Petroleum Reserve?

- (A) Oil Industry Development Board
- (B) Petroleum Conservation Research Association
- (C) Indian Oil Corporation
- (D) Indian Strategic Petroleum Reserves Limited

Q4.

Assertion (A): India's Strategic Petroleum Reserve is meant to cushion the country against global oil shocks.

Reason (R): The reserve is kept full at all times and is never drawn down.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Bikaner, a proposed SPR site, lies in which Indian state?

- (A) Rajasthan
- (B) Odisha
- (C) Gujarat
- (D) Karnataka

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. More than 80% of India's LPG imports transit the Strait of Hormuz.
- II. The Essential Commodities Act, 1955 was invoked to ensure LPG availability.
- III. The global norm is to maintain 60 days of net oil import reserves.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. India's Strategic Petroleum Reserve has a total capacity of 5.33 million tonnes.
- II. LNG is natural gas cooled to about minus 160 degrees Celsius so that it becomes liquid.
- III. Chandikhol is a proposed SPR site, not a new one.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Factors Behind the Open War

Pakistan and Afghanistan have disputed several issues along their shared frontier for years, and these disputes lie behind the current confrontation. One issue is cross-border militancy. Pakistan accuses the Afghan Taliban of allegedly sheltering the Tehrik-i-Taliban Pakistan, which is accused of launching attacks across the border into Pakistan.

A second issue concerns the boundary itself. The Durand Line separates the two countries, and its status has been contested for a long time. Afghan governments have historically questioned its legitimacy.

Tensions also turned into direct fighting. Clashes at disputed checkpoints escalated into military confrontation. Pakistan launched an operation against Afghan military bases, and Afghanistan retaliated with airstrikes on Pakistani targets.

The Taliban had returned to full control in 2021 after the US withdrawal, and Pakistan initially welcomed that development. However, tensions resurfaced as cross-border militancy continued. India condemned Pakistan's attacks and reaffirmed its support for Afghanistan's sovereignty, territorial integrity and independence.

Q1.

Afghanistan's objection to the Durand Line is that the agreement was signed under which kind of pressure?

- (A) Soviet military pressure
- (B) Mughal territorial claims
- (C) Colonial pressure
- (D) Persian diplomatic pressure

Q2.

Which Pakistani doctrine has been eroded by the Taliban's outreach to India?

- (A) Strategic depth
- (B) Nuclear deterrence
- (C) Forward defence
- (D) Economic corridor

Q3.

Repeated closures of the Torkham crossing pushed Kabul toward which kind of routes?

- (A) Chinese rail routes
- (B) Russian airways
- (C) Indian sea lanes
- (D) Iranian routes

Q4.

Assertion (A): Pakistan considers the Durand Line a legal international boundary.

Reason (R): Afghan forces have resisted Pakistan's border fencing.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Durand Line	A. Erosion by Taliban outreach to India
II. Nur Khan Airbase	B. Division HQ in Quetta
III. 12th Division HQ	C. Divided Pashtun tribal populations
IV. Strategic depth	D. Airbase in Rawalpindi

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Afghanistan officially recognises the Durand Line as a permanent border.
- II. Repeated closures of the Torkham crossing have hurt Afghan trade.
- III. Pakistan was one of the few countries to recognise the Taliban regime in the 1990s.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Taliban captured Kabul in 1996.
- II. Afghanistan's monarchy ended in 1979.
- III. The Shahtoot Dam Project of 2021 was launched to provide drinking water to Kabul.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) All of the above
- (D) Only two

What the Conflict Means for India

Fighting between Pakistan and Afghanistan has consequences that reach beyond the two countries. The booklet discusses the effects on India under a separate heading, covering India's western border, its security and its trade links.

Afghanistan has seen many changes of government. Its monarchy ended in 1973, and a communist government backed by the Soviet Union followed. After the US withdrawal in August 2021, the Taliban regained full control of the country.

Pakistan first welcomed the Taliban's return, but tensions resurfaced as cross-border militancy

continued. The Afghan Taliban is allegedly sheltering the Tehrik-i-Taliban Pakistan, which is accused of cross-border attacks. Border crossings have also been shut more than once, and these closures have hurt Afghan trade.

The fighting began when Pakistan launched an operation against Afghan military bases. Afghanistan replied with airstrikes on Pakistani targets, and the confrontation became a direct military one.

Q1.

Afghanistan is described as a crossroad between South Asia and Central Asia, and between South Asia and which other region?

- (A) East Asia
- (B) Southeast Asia
- (C) Middle East
- (D) Eastern Europe

Q2.

What did India do regarding Pakistan's attacks on Afghanistan?

- (A) Welcomed them
- (B) Offered to mediate
- (C) Ignored them
- (D) Condemned them

Q3.

Along with sovereignty and territorial integrity, what did India reaffirm for Afghanistan?

- (A) Democracy
- (B) Neutrality
- (C) Federal structure
- (D) Independence

Q4.

Assertion (A): A full-scale conflict risks an Afghan refugee inflow onto India's borders.

Reason (R): Prolonged instability risks allowing ISIS-K to regroup and expand across South Asia.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Connectivity Risks	A. Afghan refugee inflow onto India's borders
II. Terror Spillover	B. Access to INSTC jeopardised
III. Refugee Pressure	C. Reduced infiltration pressure along the LoC
IV. LoC Relief	D. ISIS-K regroup and expand across South Asia

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Afghanistan officially recognises the Durand Line as a permanent border.
- II. The conflict jeopardises India's access to the INSTC.
- III. Afghanistan argues that the Durand Line was a temporary arrangement.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Taliban captured Kabul in 1996.
- II. Afghanistan's monarchy ended in 1979.
- III. The Shahtoot Dam Project of 2021 was launched to provide drinking water to Kabul.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Nepal's Political System and Parties

Nepal's political life rests on a written constitution that sets out how power is divided among the country's institutions. The constitutional framework covers the type of government, the offices of President and Prime Minister, the structure of Parliament and the electoral system. Under this framework, a President acts as the ceremonial head of state, while a Prime Minister leads the government. Parliament is the body through which laws are made.

Elections to Parliament use more than one method of choosing representatives, so seats are filled through different processes. Several parties have shaped Nepal's public life for decades. The Nepali Congress, the CPN-UML and the CPN-Maoist Centre are among the best-known, and each has been led by prominent figures over time. Pushpa Kamal Dahal, widely known as Prachanda, is the present leader of the CPN-Maoist Centre, while KP Sharma Oli leads the CPN-UML.

Nepal has historically struggled with political instability. Governments have changed often since the return of democracy, and the country's political system has passed through several distinct phases over the decades. Nepal's politics has also moved through several phases, including a monarchy, the Panchayat system and the return of democracy. A people's movement in 1990 ended the Panchayat system and made the monarchy ceremonial.

Q1.

What type of government does Nepal follow under its current constitutional framework?

- (A) Unitary presidential republic
- (B) Constitutional monarchy
- (C) Federal Democratic Republic with a Multi-Party System
- (D) Theocratic state

Q2.

Who founded the Nepali Congress?

- (A) Man Mohan Adhikari
- (B) Pushpa Kamal Dahal
- (C) Bishweshwar Prasad Koirala
- (D) Madan Bhandari

Q3.

Under which electoral method is the seat won by the candidate with the highest number of votes?

- (A) First-past-the-post
- (B) Proportional representation
- (C) Two-round system
- (D) Indirect election

Q4.

Assertion (A): Nepal's Parliament is bicameral.

Reason (R): Parliament comprises the House of Representatives and the National Assembly.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Nepali Congress	A. 1991
II. CPN-UML	B. 1994
III. CPN-Maoist Centre	C. 2015
IV. Constitution of Nepal	D. 1947

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Read the statements below.

- I. Nepal has historically struggled with political instability, and no government has completed a full term since 1990.
- II. Under FPTP, seats are allocated according to each party's share of the votes.
- III. Parliament has only a single chamber.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II only
- (D) I only

Q7.

How many of the statements below are correct?

- I. The House of Representatives has 165 FPTP seats and 110 PR seats.
 - II. CPN-UML was founded in 1947.
 - III. KP Sharma Oli succeeded Pushpa Kamal Dahal (Prachanda) as Prime Minister.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

India-Nepal Ties: Relations and Strains

India and Nepal share a long and close relationship, shaped by geography, culture and history. Nepal acts as a Himalayan buffer state between India and another large neighbour, and India is

Nepal's largest trade partner. Both countries are founding members of regional groupings in South Asia, and their armed forces have held joint exercises.

Trade, investment and connectivity projects are central to the ties. Cross-border infrastructure, including rail and power links, has been part of the agenda between the two governments.

The relationship has also seen strains. Border disputes persist in several places along the frontier, and Nepal has questioned some older agreements that govern the ties. Changes in Nepal's political landscape can alter how the two governments engage with one another. Military and cultural ties have long linked the two countries. Nepali soldiers have served in the British Indian Army since the Treaty of Sugauli, and Gorkha regiments in the Indian Army are partly recruited from Nepal's hill districts. Cultural links include the Ramayana tradition and the birthplace of the Buddha at Lumbini. Several sister-city arrangements link towns in the two countries, including Kathmandu and Varanasi. Religious and historical links also run deep, reflecting a long civilisational connection. The relationship therefore combines cooperation with occasional disagreement.

Q1.

Which Indian policy might RSP's technocratic approach align with, especially on cross-border rail, power grid and infrastructure?

- (A) Neighbourhood First Policy
- (B) Look East Policy
- (C) Act East Policy
- (D) Panchsheel Agreement

Q2.

Revisiting the 1950 Treaty of Peace and Friendship could have which effect on India?

- (A) It would increase India's traditional diplomatic leverage in Kathmandu
- (B) It would end all cross-border trade between the two countries
- (C) It could reduce India's traditional diplomatic leverage in Kathmandu
- (D) It would remove the Kalapani dispute from negotiations

Q3.

Nepal's effort to reduce its dependence on India may redirect trade and connectivity projects toward which other partner?

- (A) China
- (B) Bangladesh
- (C) Bhutan
- (D) Sri Lanka

Q4.

Read the statements below.

- I. RSP proposes revisiting the 1950 India-Nepal Treaty of Peace and Friendship.
- II. A single-party majority government could provide a stable environment for long-term policy.
- III. Madhesh lies in the hill region of Nepal.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the statements below are correct?

- I. The Kalapani dispute could harden Nepal's stance under Shah's assertive nationalism.
 - II. Madhesh has historically demanded greater political representation.
 - III. Nepal considers the 1950 treaty fully equal and up to date.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Q6.

Madhesh lies in which part of Nepal?

- (A) Mountain region of north-western Nepal
- (B) Hill region of central Nepal
- (C) Himalayan plateau of north-eastern Nepal
- (D) Terai plains of south-eastern Nepal

Background of Bilateral Ties: MCQ practice

India and Canada are working to reset their relationship. During a visit to India, Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney signalled this reset, and cooperation between the two countries was described as widening across trade, energy and technology. The visit produced several outcomes in different sectors. Canada announced its intent to join the International Solar Alliance and was upgraded to full membership of the Global Biofuels Alliance. Both sides also signed a memorandum of understanding to build secure and resilient supply chains in critical minerals, an effort that aligns with the G7 Critical Minerals Action Plan. The minerals memorandum is one of the outcomes cited in the booklet. Canada will offer fully funded research internships to 300 Indian students each year. India remains the largest source of international students to Canada. The two countries also conduct joint research, which is part of the wider relationship. A technology and innovation partnership was launched to focus on emerging technologies, digital innovation and advanced manufacturing. In agriculture, a centre of excellence was established to work on fortified pulse products and food innovation. Many of these outcomes were announced during the same visit. Each outcome is linked to a specific sector, from solar energy to agriculture. Taken together, these outcomes cover energy, minerals, education, technology and agriculture.

Q1.

Which Indian agency collaborates with the Canadian Space Agency?

- (A) NASA
- (B) ESA
- (C) ISRO
- (D) JAXA

Q2.

Bilateral trade between India and Canada was worth how much in 2024?

- (A) USD 13.9 billion
- (B) USD 21.4 billion
- (C) USD 40.2 billion
- (D) USD 30.9 billion

Q3.

In which year did Canada assist India in building the CIRUS nuclear research reactor?

- (A) 1947
- (B) 2013
- (C) 1962
- (D) 1954

Q4.

Read the statements.

Assertion (A): The Nuclear Cooperation Agreement facilitates uranium supply and oversight.

Reason (R): The Nuclear Cooperation Agreement was dated 2013.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Diplomatic ties established	A. 1954
II. CIRUS reactor	B. USD 30.9 billion
III. Nuclear Cooperation Agreement	C. 1947
IV. Bilateral trade in 2024	D. 2013

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

I. ISRO collaborates with the Canadian Space Agency.

II. Canada assisted India in building the CIRUS reactor in 1954.

III. The Nuclear Cooperation Agreement is dated 2010.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

The Nuclear Cooperation Agreement facilitates uranium supply and oversight.

Diplomatic ties between India and Canada were established in 1957.

Bilateral trade was worth USD 30.9 billion in 2024.

ISRO collaborates with the Canadian Space Agency.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Khalistan Movement: MCQ practice

The Khalistan movement is rooted in Sikh identity, history and faith, and in politics around Punjab. Sikh identity is marked by the Khalsa tradition, which also stresses autonomy. Several security operations were carried out against militancy in Punjab over the years. One operation focused on capturing militants from the outskirts of Punjab. The movement also has an international dimension. Diaspora-based separatists leveraged political influence in host countries, and some

groups were organised to gain legitimacy and keep the issue alive. Pakistan's alleged support, including arms, funds and safe havens for militants, intensified hostilities. Periodic violence has been linked to Khalistani elements, and such elements have disrupted Indian diplomatic missions overseas. Indian counter-insurgency tactics have been criticised by global agencies, which has raised human rights concerns. Trade agreements have also been affected by political friction over the issue. Security and human rights concerns have both been part of the debate. The movement also has geopolitical implications, including concerns about India's sovereignty. Violent episodes have shaped the issue, and diaspora activism continues to affect bilateral ties. Continued radicalisation has been noted as a concern.

Q1.

The Khalsa tradition, which marks Sikh identity and autonomy, was established in which year?

- (A) 1947
- (B) 1984
- (C) 1966
- (D) 1699

Q2.

Which resolution demanded greater autonomy for Punjab?

- (A) Punjabi Suba Movement
- (B) Dharam Yudh Morcha
- (C) Anandpur Sahib Resolution
- (D) Operation Woodrose

Q3.

Which operation removed militants from the Golden Temple?

- (A) Operation Black Thunder
- (B) Operation Woodrose
- (C) Dharam Yudh Morcha
- (D) Punjabi Suba Movement

Q4.

Read the statements.

Assertion (A): Operation Woodrose was a crackdown on Khalistani supporters across Punjab.

Reason (R): Operation Black Thunder removed militants from the Golden Temple.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Anandpur Sahib Resolution	A. Face of Sikh militancy advocating Khalistan
II. Operation Black Thunder	B. Crackdown on Khalistani supporters across Punjab
III. Operation Woodrose	C. Removal of militants from the Golden Temple
IV. Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale	D. Demand for greater autonomy for Punjab

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

The Partition of India in 1947 left Sikhs as a minority.

The Anandpur Sahib Resolution demanded greater autonomy for Punjab.

Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale advocated Khalistan.

The Air India bombing was carried out by Sikh extremists based in the UK.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Vienna Conventions and Diplomatic Immunity: MCQ practice

Relations between India and Canada have been tested by a series of disputes in recent years. The booklet presents these disputes as major challenges in the relationship. One of them followed the killing of a Khalistani leader, after which allegations were made about a possible link with Indian agents. The disputes also raised questions about the rules that govern diplomats and their missions. Two international agreements set the framework for diplomatic and consular relations between nations. These agreements cover the status of diplomats, the premises of diplomatic missions and the work of consular officers. The conventions describe the protections that diplomats and consular officers receive, and the booklet summarises them as key provisions. Diplomatic ties between the two countries have deteriorated in this period. Economic ties have also been affected, and the rifts have created uncertainty about Canadian investment in India. Students and applicants are among those affected by these challenges, according to the booklet. Visa and immigration matters form one of these challenges. The booklet also notes that the disputes have been linked to the wider geopolitical context. Against this background, Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney signalled a reset with India during his visit, and the two sides moved to widen cooperation across trade, energy and technology.

Q1.

The Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations is dated to which year?

- (A) 1947
- (B) 1963
- (C) 1961
- (D) 1984

Q2.

Diplomats are protected from which of the following?

- (A) Arrest and legal processes
- (B) Travel between capitals
- (C) Public criticism
- (D) Visa applications

Q3.

Amid the diplomatic dispute, which step did both countries take?

- (A) Merging their diplomatic services
- (B) Signing a new trade treaty
- (C) Launching a new Vienna Convention
- (D) Expelling diplomats and freezing consular services

Q4.

Read the statements.

Assertion (A): Consular officers can perform their duties without interference.

Reason (R): Missions cannot be entered without permission.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Diplomatic immunity	A. Consular officers can perform duties without interference
II. Inviolability of diplomatic premises	B. Dated 1963
III. Protection of consular officers	C. Protection from arrest and legal processes
IV. Vienna Convention on Consular Relations	D. Missions cannot be entered without permission

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

I. The Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations is dated 1961.

II. The Vienna Convention on Consular Relations is dated 1961.

III. Diplomatic immunity protects diplomats from arrest and legal processes.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

Consular officers can perform duties without interference.

Missions can be entered without permission.

The Vienna Convention on Consular Relations is dated 1963.

The Vienna Convention on Consular Relations is dated 1961.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Union, New States and Article 4

The opening portion of the Constitution of India is concerned with the Union and its territory. It sets out the name of the country and the basic character of its government, even though the document gives the country a federal structure. The names of the States and Union Territories, along with the extent of their territory, are listed in a schedule to the Constitution, and the number

of these units has changed over time. At the time of independence in 1947, the country was made up of British Provinces and Princely States. Legislation passed in 1947 had created two separate dominions, and the Princely States were given three choices: to join India, to join Pakistan, or to remain independent. Most of the Princely States joined India, although a few refused to do so at first. Those that stayed apart were later integrated by different means. The Constitution of 1950 then classified the States and territories into four groups. The same opening provisions allow Parliament to take up new States and changes to existing ones through laws it passes. Whether such laws must follow the procedure used for constitutional amendments is answered by the Constitution itself.

Q1.

Under Article 2, admission refers to which category of States?

- (A) States already in existence
- (B) States not in existence before
- (C) States formed by merging Union Territories
- (D) Princely States that refused to join India

Q2.

Which Article describes India, that is Bharat, as a Union of States rather than a Federation of States?

- (A) Article 1
- (B) Article 2
- (C) Article 3
- (D) Article 4

Q3.

Which schedule of the Constitution lists the names of States and Union Territories and their territorial extent?

- (A) Second Schedule
- (B) First Schedule
- (C) Third Schedule
- (D) Seventh Schedule

Q4.

Assertion (A): Creation of a new State under Article 2 requires a constitutional amendment under Article 368.

Reason (R): Article 4 declares that laws made under Articles 2 and 3 are not amendments under Article 368.

In the light of the above statements, choose the correct answer from the options given below.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 1	A. Laws under Articles 2 and 3 are not amendments under Article 368
II. Article 2	B. Reorganisation of States, including altering boundaries and names
III. Article 3	C. Name of the country and type of polity
IV. Article 4	D. Admission or establishment of new States

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Articles 1 to 4 fall under Part I of the Constitution.
- II. Article 4 treats laws made under Articles 2 and 3 as amendments under Article 368.
- III. The First Schedule lists the names of States and Union Territories with their territorial extent.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Laws made under Articles 2 and 3 can be passed by a simple majority in Parliament.
 - II. Laws made under Articles 2 and 3 are amendments under Article 368 and need a special majority.
 - III. Article 1 deals with the name of the country and the type of polity.
- (A) Only two
 - (B) Only one
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Early History of Caste-Based Reservation: MCQ

The idea of caste-based reservation in India was first proposed in 1882, long before the present Constitution came into force. During British rule, elements of reservation took the form of separate electorates, a system in which members of a particular community chose their own representatives. This arrangement was not confined to a single group. Over time, the British applied separate electorates to several categories of people, and the arrangements were revised more than once.

After independence, the question of reservation was taken up within the new constitutional framework. The Constitution's guarantees of equality shaped how any special treatment could be provided, and courts were asked to examine whether particular measures were valid under them. Governments therefore had to fit their policies within these limits, and the judiciary had a decisive role in deciding where the limits lay.

Commissions were also set up to study the condition of backward classes, and their findings informed policy. Courts, in turn, ruled on reservation policies in several important cases, and those

rulings set out conditions and ceilings that governments must observe when they design reservation schemes. The result is a system in which political choices and legal review have shaped each other over the decades.

Q1.

Consider the following statements about the MR Balaji case (1963):

- I. The case was against the State of Mysore.
- II. The Court ordered the government to keep reservation at 50 per cent.
- III. The judgement was delivered in 1979.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q2.

Assertion (A): The Kalelkar Commission was set up in 1953.

Reason (R): The Kalelkar Commission identified only Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Which groups did the Government of India Act of 1935 extend separate electorates to?

- (A) Depressed Classes only
- (B) Depressed Classes, Women and Labour
- (C) Women and Labour only
- (D) Depressed Classes and Labour only

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. IR Coelho case (2007)	A. Upheld the 103rd Amendment (EWS reservation)
II. Janhit Abhiyan case (2022)	B. Abandoned separate electorates for Depressed Classes
III. Kalelkar Commission (1953)	C. Laws placed in the 9th Schedule after 24 April 1973 subject to judicial review
IV. Poona Pact	D. First Backward Class Commission (national level)

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

Q5.

Who first proposed caste-based reservation in 1882?

- (A) B.R. Ambedkar and Mahatma Gandhi
- (B) B.G. Tilak and Gopal Krishna Gokhale
- (C) Jawaharlal Nehru and Sardar Patel
- (D) William Hunter and Jyotirao Phule

Q6.

Which Constitutional Amendment added Article 15(4) to legalise caste-based reservation?

- (A) 1st Amendment, 1950
- (B) 7th Amendment, 1956
- (C) 9th Amendment, 1960
- (D) 1st Amendment, 1951

Later Judgements and EWS Reservation: MCQ

Judgements after the early 1990s have refined how reservation works. Courts have considered whether the State must provide reservation in promotions, how laws placed in the Ninth Schedule are treated, and which members of a reserved group should be excluded from its benefits. Such rulings have set conditions that governments must meet before they can act.

The Constitution has also been amended to address economically weaker sections. One amendment introduced a quota for these groups, and the Supreme Court later examined it. The same route of constitutional change was used for women. Another amendment set aside a share of seats in Parliament and State Legislatures for women, and these seats may be allotted by rotation among constituencies. The reservation is not permanent, and the provision was designed to lapse after a fixed period.

Economic criteria have therefore entered the reservation framework alongside social criteria. The basic principle of reserving seats or posts for disadvantaged groups remains, but the basis on which groups are identified has widened. Each new measure must still be tested against the Constitution's guarantees, and the courts examine whether it meets the required conditions. This is why each change in the rules is closely examined in the courts and by the government that proposes it.

Q1.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Commission for Economically Backward Classes was constituted in 2005.
- II. The 102nd Constitutional Amendment Act was passed in 2018.
- III. The Janhit Abhiyan judgement was delivered in 2018.

- (A) Only one
- (B) All of the above
- (C) Only two
- (D) Only three

Q2.

Consider the following statements about the Nagaraj case (2006) and the Jarnail Singh case (2018):

- I. A State must show that it does not compromise on efficiency of administration.
- II. A State must prove inadequate representation of the class in public employment.
- III. The Jarnail Singh case requires quantifiable data for reservation in promotions for SCs and STs.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q3.

Assertion (A): Under the Jarnail Singh judgement (2018), the State must collect quantifiable data on SC/ST backwardness before giving reservation in promotions.

Reason (R): The Nagaraj case (2006) laid down that a State must collect quantifiable data on backwardness before providing reservation in promotions.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

What share of seats did the 106th Amendment Act reserve for women in Parliament and State Legislatures?

- (A) One-fourth
- (B) One-half
- (C) One-third
- (D) One-fifth

Q5.

Which Constitutional Amendment provided 10 per cent reservation for Economically Weaker Sections (EWS)?

- (A) 101st Amendment
- (B) 102nd Amendment
- (C) 103rd Amendment
- (D) 106th Amendment

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Janhit Abhiyan case (2022)	A. Reservation in promotions does not need quantifiable data
II. Commission for Economically Backward Classes	B. Gave constitutional status to the NCBC
III. 102nd Constitutional Amendment (2018)	C. Report submitted in July 2010
IV. Jarnail Singh case (2018)	D. Upheld the 103rd Amendment

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D

Q7.

For how many years will the reservation of seats for women under the 106th Amendment remain in effect?

- (A) 15 years
- (B) 10 years
- (C) 20 years
- (D) 25 years

National Commission for Backward Classes: MCQ

A permanent body for backward classes was first envisaged in a 1992 judgement on reservation. The judgement directed that a permanent statutory body should be set up to examine complaints of over-inclusion and under-inclusion in the list of backward classes, so that benefits reach those who need them. Errors in either direction, whether a community is wrongly included or wrongly left out,

were what the direction aimed to address. The aim was to keep the list accurate so that the reservation system works as intended.

The second Backward Classes Commission is one example of the inquiries that preceded this idea. It was appointed to study the conditions of socially and educationally backward classes and to suggest measures for their advancement, and its work dealt with the same underlying question of who needs support.

The national body that was eventually created came through an Act of Parliament. Its work concerns the welfare of backward classes and the examination of matters that affect them. Because it operates within the wider framework of reservation, its findings bear on the economic criteria that decide who is excluded from benefits, and on how reservation is shared among groups. Its role is therefore closely tied to the working of reservation as a whole.

Q1.

In which year was the National Commission for Backward Classes set up by an Act of Parliament?

- (A) 1990
- (B) 2002
- (C) 1993
- (D) 2018

Q2.

Under which Article of the Constitution was constitutional status given to the NCBC?

- (A) Article 320
- (B) Article 342A
- (C) Article 340
- (D) Article 338B

Q3.

Assertion (A): The conditions of service and tenure of the NCBC's members are determined by the President.

Reason (R): The NCBC was set up in 1993.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 338B	A. Members appointed by the President by warrant under his hand and seal
II. Article 342A	B. Chairperson, Vice-Chairperson and three other members
III. Composition of the NCBC	C. Empowers the President to specify backward classes in States and UTs
IV. Warrant under hand and seal	D. Gave constitutional status and wider functions to the NCBC

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the National Commission for Backward Classes:

- I. The NCBC can recommend the income level that excludes the creamy layer from reservation benefits.
- II. The NCBC members are appointed by the Prime Minister.
- III. The NCBC can investigate complaints relating to backward classes.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The NCBC's members are appointed by the President by warrant under his hand and seal.
- II. The NCBC was set up by an Act of Parliament in 1963.
- III. The NCBC was set up by the original Constitution in 1950.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q7.

Which Constitutional Amendment Act of 2018 gave the NCBC constitutional status?

- (A) 101st Amendment
- (B) 103rd Amendment
- (C) 102nd Amendment
- (D) 106th Amendment

Penal and Council Provisions: MCQ

The Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019 was enacted after the Supreme Court's judgment in NALSA vs Union of India, which recognised transgender people as a third gender and granted them legal recognition and rights. The 2019 Act was passed to provide protection of rights of transgender persons and their welfare. The government has now presented the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Amendment Bill, 2026 in the Lok Sabha to revise that Act. The Bill narrows the definition of transgender person and removes some categories, including trans-man, trans-woman and genderqueer. It also makes the penal framework stronger by expanding penal provisions. The offences it covers include forced mutilation of minors and the forcing of children into begging. The Bill requires medical institutions to report gender-affirming surgeries to an official authority. Under the Bill, certificate holders are allowed to change their name in official documents. The Bill further revises the composition of the National Council for Transgender Persons. The Bill's proposals have drawn both support and criticism, with critics pointing to the earlier Supreme Court judgment and supporters pointing to the aim of welfare. Its changes affect the penal, reporting and naming provisions of the law. These changes are discussed alongside the wider significance of the Bill.

Q1.

Who nominates the members of the National Council for Transgender Persons under the Bill?

- (A) State Governments
- (B) Supreme Court
- (C) Central Government
- (D) National Human Rights Commission

Q2.

What is the maximum imprisonment the Bill prescribes for forcing children into begging?

- (A) Up to 14 years
- (B) Up to 7 years
- (C) Up to 10 years
- (D) Life imprisonment

Q3.

Which punishment does the Bill prescribe for forced mutilation of minors?

- (A) Up to 14 years imprisonment
- (B) Up to 7 years imprisonment
- (C) Fine only
- (D) Life imprisonment

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Forced mutilation of minors	A. District Magistrate
II. Forcing children into begging	B. Central Government
III. Reporting of gender-affirming surgeries	C. Up to 14 years
IV. Nomination of Council members	D. Life imprisonment

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D

Q5.

Read the following statements:

- I. Medical institutions must report gender-affirming surgeries to the District Magistrate.
- II. Forcing children into begging can attract up to 14 years of imprisonment.
- III. Members of the National Council are nominated by State Governments.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

Life imprisonment is prescribed for forced mutilation of minors.

Forcing children into begging attracts up to 14 years of imprisonment.

Members of the National Council are nominated by State Governments.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Significance and Criticism: MCQ

The Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019 was passed to provide protection of rights of transgender persons and their welfare. The NALSA judgment in 2014 recognised transgender people as a third gender, and that recognition forms part of the background to the

debate. The Union Government has now presented an Amendment Bill, 2026 in the Lok Sabha to revise that Act. The Bill narrows the definition of transgender person and makes the penal framework stronger by expanding penal provisions. Under the Bill, a Medical Board led by a Chief Medical Officer or Deputy CMO would verify transgender identity, and certificate holders could change their name in official documents. The Bill has drawn both support and criticism in public debate. Supporters argue that the Bill is meant to improve welfare for transgender persons. They also point out that mandatory reporting can support national planning for healthcare and welfare schemes. Critics question the Bill's approach and raise several concerns about it. They say that the verification process raises questions of its own. They also raise other concerns about the proposals, and they warn that some broad legal terms could be misused. The debate therefore covers welfare, certification, reporting and the wording of the law.

Q1.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Verification by Medical Board	A. May restrict voluntary gender transition support
II. Mandatory reporting of surgeries	B. Aims to ensure benefits reach the most marginalised
III. Narrow definition of transgender person	C. May pathologise gender identity
IV. Terms like 'Inducement' or 'Allurement'	D. May violate medical confidentiality

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q2.

Under the Bill, broad terms such as 'Inducement' or 'Allurement' could be used against which two groups?

- (A) Police officers and judges
- (B) Schools and universities
- (C) Trade unions and banks
- (D) NGOs and healthcare providers

Q3.

How many of the following statements are correct?

Mandatory reporting of surgeries may violate medical confidentiality and personal privacy.

The NALSA judgment recognised gender identity as a statutory right.

The penal framework addresses abduction.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q4.

Which offences does the Bill's penal framework address, according to the booklet?

- (A) Mutilation, abduction and forced identity
- (B) Tax evasion and smuggling
- (C) Defamation and sedition
- (D) Cyber fraud and forgery

Q5.

Read the following points about the Bill:

- I. The narrower definition is intended to direct welfare to the most marginalised communities.
- II. The removal of self-identification is consistent with the NALSA judgment.
- III. Medical Board verification may pathologise gender identity.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

According to the booklet, what effect do Medical Boards have on the discretionary power of District Magistrates?

- (A) They increase the discretionary power of District Magistrates
- (B) They have no connection with District Magistrates
- (C) They replace District Magistrates in issuing certificates entirely
- (D) They reduce the discretionary power of District Magistrates

Figures Under the Revised Series

The New National Accounts Series was released by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation, with the base year for Gross Domestic Product revised to 2022-23. The new series uses improved estimation methods and aligns with the System of National Accounts 2008. It integrates high-frequency and administrative datasets, including GST collections, vehicle registration data and the Periodic Labour Force Survey. The base year 2022-23 was chosen because it represents the most recent normal economic year after the COVID-19 disruptions. The revision also changes how government finances are estimated, and the national accounts now capture more platform workers and hired domestic workers than before. Headline figures for the year 2025-26 are presented afresh under the new base year. The revision seeks to improve the accuracy and credibility of the national accounts. The new series also reflects the digital economy and new sectors more closely, so that the measured economy reflects present production structures. Improved methodologies and granular data enhance the accuracy of the economic growth rate. Statistical reforms modernise India's data system through updated CPI, IIP and WPI base years, strengthening the national framework. The Periodic revision of the base year follows guidelines of the United Nations Statistical Commission. The series covers gig work and household enterprises as well.

Q1.

What is the revised real GDP growth rate for FY 2025-26?

- (A) 6.5%
- (B) 7.6%
- (C) 8.9%
- (D) 9.5%

Q2.

By what percentage did the secondary sector grow in FY 2025-26?

- (A) 7.3%
- (B) 8.3%
- (C) 9.5%
- (D) 8.9%

Q3.

What is the revised fiscal deficit as a percentage of GDP?

- (A) 4.51%
- (B) 4.36%
- (C) 55.6%
- (D) 57.5%

Q4.

Assertion (A): The revised series lowers the debt-to-GDP ratio estimate for FY 2026-27 below the earlier target.

Reason (R): Lower nominal GDP can raise debt-to-GDP ratios despite unchanged absolute deficit levels.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Primary sector growth in FY 2025-26	A. 9.5%
II. Secondary sector growth in FY 2025-26	B. 7.6%
III. Tertiary sector growth in FY 2025-26	C. 2.8%
IV. Real GDP growth for FY 2025-26	D. 8.9%

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the revised figures:

- I. The revised debt-to-GDP ratio estimate for FY 2026-27 is 57.5%.
- II. The earlier target for the debt-to-GDP ratio was 57.5%.
- III. More accurate economic data supports policy formulation, investment and business decisions.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Examine the statements given below and find how many are correct.

- I. The primary sector growth for FY 2025-26 is 2.8%.
- II. The revised fiscal deficit is 4.36% of GDP.
- III. The revised real GDP growth for FY 2025-26 is 7.6%.

How many of these statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

India and BRICS: MCQ Practice

The World Happiness Report is an annual ranking of countries based on how people evaluate their own lives. Respondents are asked to rate their lives on a numbered scale, and the results are read together with six key indicators. These indicators are GDP per capita, social support, healthy life expectancy, freedom, generosity and perception of corruption. Because the report looks at these factors together, it helps countries assess development beyond GDP alone.

The report does not compare countries only on one global list. It also places countries within regional and economic groups, so that a country can be seen against its neighbours and against the other members of BRICS. India is one of the countries studied in South Asia, and its position can be read alongside the positions of its neighbours. Such comparisons show how a country stands relative to others in its own group.

India's place in the 2026 edition can also be compared with its earlier position, because rankings can move from one edition to the next. A change in rank is shown alongside the country's score, so the movement and the level of well-being can be read together. Areas where a country has improved are also identified in the report.

The 2026 report was released on International Day of Happiness, which is observed every year on 20 March. The report emphasises well-being as a policy goal.

Q1.

Which BRICS nation ranked highest in the 2026 World Happiness Report?

- (A) Russia
- (B) Iran
- (C) China
- (D) India

Q2.

India's 2026 rank was an improvement from which earlier position?

- (A) 118th
- (B) 120th
- (C) 112th
- (D) 108th

Q3.

Which two areas were identified as areas of improvement for India in the 2026 report?

- (A) GDP per capita and freedom
- (B) Generosity and perception of corruption
- (C) Freedom and perception of corruption
- (D) Social support and healthy life expectancy

Q4.

Assertion (A): India ranked below Nepal and Pakistan in the 2026 report.

Reason (R): Sri Lanka was placed 134th in the 2026 report.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Russia	A. 104th
II. Iran	B. 99th
III. Nepal	C. 97th
IV. Pakistan	D. 79th

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements about India and BRICS in the 2026 report:

- I. India ranked above Bangladesh.
- II. Russia ranked above China.
- III. Pakistan ranked above Iran.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

Consider the following statements about India in the 2026 report:

- I. India ranked above Nepal.
- II. India ranked below Pakistan.
- III. India ranked above Sri Lanka.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Social Media and Youth: MCQ Practice

The 2026 World Happiness Report examines how social media use relates to happiness among young people. The report looks at life satisfaction across age groups, comparing how people in different age brackets rate their lives. It also considers how much time young people spend on these platforms, rather than treating all use as the same. The study is therefore about patterns of use as well as the simple fact of using these platforms. Life satisfaction in the report is measured through people's own ratings of their lives, which allows the results to be compared across groups and countries. The findings are presented as a set of key insights. Some of these insights concern developing countries, where the effects of digital tools are discussed separately. The report also describes situations in which the same tools bring strain. Its findings suggest that the amount of use matters, since some levels of use are associated with lower well-being than others. Taken together, these insights help show how young people are faring in a digital environment. The report was released on International Day of Happiness, and it is part of the annual series published under the World Happiness Report name.

Q1.

According to the report, which group is the most vulnerable to social media use?

- (A) Elderly men using social media over 3 hours a day
- (B) Adolescent girls using social media over 5 hours a day
- (C) Young boys aged 10-14 using social media over 4 hours a day
- (D) Working adults using social media over 6 hours a day

Q2.

In which group of countries was the age-based pattern of youth life satisfaction observed?

- (A) India, Nepal, Pakistan and Bangladesh
- (B) Finland, Iceland, Denmark and Costa Rica
- (C) United States, Canada, Australia and New Zealand
- (D) China, Russia, Iran and Pakistan

Q3.

Assertion (A): Youth aged 15 to 24 report lower life satisfaction than people aged 60 and above.

Reason (R): The report provides insights into mental health and digital behaviour trends.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Developing countries like India	A. Decline in mental health and comparison-driven stress
II. Excessive use in the same settings	B. Digital access improves education and connectivity
III. Heavy social media use	C. Lower life satisfaction than those aged 60 and above
IV. Youth aged 15 to 24	D. Stress and anxiety

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the report's findings on social media:

- I. Youth aged 15 to 24 report lower life satisfaction than those aged 60 and above.
- II. Adolescent girls using social media for less than five hours a day are the most vulnerable group.
- III. In developing countries like India, excessive social media use causes stress and anxiety.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements about social media use in the report:

- I. The age-based pattern was observed in Australia.
- II. Youth aged 15 to 24 report higher life satisfaction than those aged 60 and above.
- III. Excessive digital use in developing countries is linked with improved happiness.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q7.

What does the report link heavy social media use with?

- (A) Improved mental health
- (B) Decline in mental health and comparison-driven stress
- (C) Higher GDP per capita
- (D) Greater social trust

India's Arms Import Sources

The Stockholm International Peace Research Institute, known as SIPRI, is an independent international research institute. It has its headquarters in Stockholm, Sweden. Its focus areas include conflict and peace studies, armaments and military expenditure, arms transfers and disarmament. The institute released a report titled Trends in International Arms Transfers 2025, which analyses global defence trade patterns. The report covers international arms transfers during the 2021-25 period and compares them with the 2016-20 period. Among its key global findings, international arms transfers increased over the comparison period, while arms imports by European countries rose sharply, a rise the report largely links to the Russia-Ukraine war. The report also records that arms exports from Russia declined, reducing its share of global exports. The United States is shown as the top exporter, followed by France, Russia, Germany and China. The findings are presented as a set of key global findings, followed by specific findings for India. India is discussed as one of the major importers in the report, and its arms imports are examined for the 2021-25 period. The analysis covers the countries that supply India and the trends in its overall import volumes. Taken together, the report provides a broad view of how weapons move between countries, and it places India within this wider pattern of global defence trade.

Q1.

Consider the following statements about India's arms imports during 2021-25.

- I. France accounted for 29% of India's arms imports.
- II. Russia accounted for 15% of India's arms imports.
- III. Israel accounted for 29% of India's arms imports.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q2.

Read the following statements.

Assertion (A): Israel was among the three main suppliers of India's arms imports during 2021-25.

Reason (R): Israel accounted for 29% of India's arms imports during 2021-25.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

What share of India's arms imports during 2021-25 came from Russia?

- (A) 29%
- (B) 15%
- (C) 40%
- (D) 8.2%

Q4.

Which country supplied 15% of India's arms imports during 2021-25?

- (A) Israel
- (B) Ukraine
- (C) Saudi Arabia
- (D) Qatar

Q5.

Which factor is linked to the decline in India's overall arms imports during 2021-25?

- (A) A shift in diplomatic relations with Russia
- (B) Reduced national defence budget
- (C) Sanctions on global arms suppliers
- (D) Increased domestic defence manufacturing and indigenisation

Q6.

What percentage of India's arms imports during 2021-25 came from France?

- (A) 15%
- (B) 29%
- (C) 40%
- (D) 6.8%

Q7.

Consider the following statements about India's arms imports during 2021-25.

- I. Increased domestic manufacturing and indigenisation efforts are linked to the decline in overall imports.
- II. Russia accounted for 29% of India's arms imports.
- III. Israel accounted for 15% of India's arms imports.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

India's Defence Self-Reliance Push

India has several government initiatives in its defence sector, which the report describes under the heading of efforts to reduce arms imports. The government has announced a defence budget for the 2026-27 year, and the report records the value of defence production and exports for the year

2024-25. Targets have also been set for production and exports for the year 2029. The rules for foreign investment in defence are structured in two parts, one for investment through the automatic route and another through the government route. Innovation in the sector is also an area of focus under the government programmes. The top three destinations for Indian defence exports are named in the report. The report sets out these figures as part of the country efforts to build its defence capacity, and the initiatives are presented together so that production, exports, investment and innovation can be read as one set of measures. Together, these measures show how the country is trying to expand its own capacity to produce defence equipment while reducing its reliance on arms bought from other countries.

Q1.

Consider the following statements about India's defence sector.

- I. The Defence Industrial Corridors are located in Uttar Pradesh and Tamil Nadu.
- II. The automatic route FDI limit in defence is 49%.
- III. iDEX stands for Innovations for Defence Excellence.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q2.

What was the value of India's defence exports in 2024-25?

- (A) Rs 12,500 crore
- (B) Rs 18,000 crore
- (C) Rs 30,000 crore
- (D) Rs 23,622 crore

Q3.

Consider the following statements about India's defence sector.

- I. iDEX supports startups and MSMEs in defence innovation.
- II. The government route permits FDI of up to 74%.
- III. Armenia is among the top three defence export destinations.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. iDEX	A. Rs 7.85 lakh crore
II. Defence Industrial Corridors	B. US, France and Armenia
III. Top three export destinations	C. Innovation support for startups and MSMEs
IV. Defence budget 2026-27	D. Uttar Pradesh and Tamil Nadu

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

Q5.

What is India's defence production target for 2029?

- (A) Rs 2 lakh crore
- (B) Rs 2.5 lakh crore
- (C) Rs 3 lakh crore
- (D) Rs 4 lakh crore

Q6.

Read the following statements.

Assertion (A): Under the Defence Acquisition Procedure 2020, Indian-made products are prioritised over foreign purchases.

Reason (R): Defence Industrial Corridors have been established in Uttar Pradesh and Tamil Nadu.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q7.

Under the government route, up to what percentage of FDI is permitted in India's defence sector?

- (A) 100%
- (B) 49%
- (C) 51%
- (D) 74%

Ancient Games and Modern Revival

The Olympic Games have a history that begins in ancient Greece, where the early Games were held at Olympia. Records of the last ancient Games are found in the history books, which shows that the tradition lasted for a long time before it came to an end. The ancient Games were later brought to an end by an order that also targeted Greek temples and statues of gods. The modern Olympic movement took shape in the late nineteenth century. A founder led its revival, and an international committee was set up to organise the movement. The first modern international event was held in a Greek city, after a royal announcement that the Games would begin again. The modern movement is now governed by an international body based in Switzerland. Over the years, the Olympics have had to adapt to changing times, and some editions were disrupted by global conflicts. India first took part in the Olympics in an early edition, and it first sent a team to the Summer Games at a later date. Indian athletes have also competed at a Winter Games held in Austria. Italy has hosted the Olympic Games on several occasions, including the Winter Games in Cortina in 1956, and Rome hosted the Summer Games in 1960.

Q1.

Which ruler banned the Olympic Games, along with Greek temples and statues of gods, in 393 AD?

- (A) King George I of Greece
- (B) Baron Pierre de Coubertin
- (C) Theodosius I
- (D) Avery Brundage

Q2.

In which year is the record of the last ancient Olympic Games found?

- (A) 261 AD
- (B) 393 AD
- (C) 776 BCE
- (D) 1896

Q3.

Who became the first female Olympic champion in history?

- (A) Charlotte Cooper (Tennis)
- (B) Margaret Abbott (Golf)
- (C) Lida Petrova (Athletics)
- (D) Dorothy Tyler (High Jump)

Q4.

Assertion (A): Women could compete at the first modern Olympic event, held at Athens in 1896.

Reason (R): Women first took part in the Olympic Games at the 1900 Paris Olympics.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Ancient Olympic Games begin at Olympia	A. 1896
II. First modern international Olympic event at Athens	B. 1894
III. Olympics cancelled due to WWI (Berlin)	C. 776 BCE
IV. International Olympic Committee established	D. 1916

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Olympic Games were cancelled in 1916 due to World War I, with Berlin as the host.
- II. The International Olympic Committee was established in 1896.
- III. Norman Pritchard, competing as a lone athlete, won two silver medals in athletics.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) All of the above

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The 2020 Olympics were postponed to 2021 because of COVID-19 restrictions.
- II. The first modern international Olympic event was held in 1900.
- III. The International Olympic Committee was established in 1894.

Of the statements above, how many are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Olympic Bodies and India's Sports Schemes

The Olympic motto, Citius, Altius, Fortius, sums up the competitive spirit that the global movement celebrates. Within India, several government programmes have been created to support sport at

different levels. Khelo India is one such effort, and it is concerned with identifying and developing athletes at both grassroots and elite levels. Its winter edition was planned for Ladakh and Jammu & Kashmir.

The national sports policy aims to enhance the quality of sports training, promote participation, and increase the number of athletes competing internationally. Doping remains a serious concern for sport. A 2023 report by the World Anti-Doping Agency found that India had the highest positivity rate for banned substances among major nations, and the Athletics Integrity Unit also recorded doping offences involving Indian athletes in track and field.

India has a long record of participation in the Games. It first took part in an early edition, first sent a team to the Summer Games at a later date, and has competed at a Winter Games held in Austria. The Milano Cortina Winter Games in 2026 were held in Italy, in the cities of Milan and Cortina d'Ampezzo.

Q1.

Which government initiative encourages mass participation in fitness activities?

- (A) Khelo India
- (B) TOPS
- (C) Fit India Movement
- (D) KIRTI Programme

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Target Olympic Podium Scheme	A. 2017
II. Khelo India	B. 2014
III. Fit India Movement	C. 2024
IV. KIRTI Programme	D. 2019

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q3.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Target Olympic Podium Scheme aims to identify and support athletes with potential to win Olympic medals.
- II. The Mission Olympic Cell monitors athletes under the Khelo India programme.
- III. The Indian Olympic Association has its headquarters in Lausanne, Switzerland.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I only

Q4.

Which body was set up in 1927 with its headquarters in New Delhi?

- (A) International Olympic Committee
- (B) Indian Olympic Association
- (C) Mission Olympic Cell
- (D) Athletics Integrity Unit

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The International Olympic Committee has its headquarters in Lausanne, Switzerland.
- II. The KIRTI Programme targets school children aged 9 to 18.
- III. The Fit India Movement was launched in 2017.

Of the statements above, how many are correct?

- (A) Only three
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Q6.

Assertion (A): The Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports is the nodal ministry for India's sports schemes.

Reason (R): A Mission Olympic Cell within the ministry monitors athletes' preparation for the Olympics under TOPS.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q7.

Which ministry is the nodal ministry for India's sports schemes?

- (A) Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports
- (B) Mission Olympic Cell
- (C) World Anti-Doping Agency
- (D) Indian Olympic Association

Global Strategy and Partners: MCQ

Tuberculosis has long been one of the world's persistent infectious diseases, and one day each year is set aside to draw attention to it. The observance is meant to raise awareness and to accelerate global efforts to eliminate TB. Much of the global response is guided by the World Health Organization's End TB Strategy, a plan that sets goals for reducing deaths and new cases, with milestones along the way so that progress can be tracked. Governments are not working alone, because partner organisations also back national programmes. Their support is meant to sit alongside the work of national health systems. Each year's observance also carries a theme, chosen to keep the message focused on a single idea. The day is marked in India as well, where a number of initiatives have been launched, including a digital platform for monitoring, awareness and citizen participation. The disease calls for attention to prevention, diagnosis and treatment alike, and the response has to address all three. Taken together, the day, the strategy and the partnerships show how the effort against TB is organised across many levels.

Q1.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. WHO End TB Strategy	A. Localised intervention in urban TB hotspots
II. Global Fund and Stop TB Partnership	B. Discovery of the TB bacterium in 1882
III. Robert Koch	C. Financial and technical support
IV. TB Mukht Urban Ward Initiative	D. Long-term global blueprint

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q2.

On which date is World Tuberculosis Day observed every year?

- (A) March 14
- (B) March 24
- (C) April 7
- (D) April 24

Q3.

What is the theme of World Tuberculosis Day 2026?

- (A) Unite to End TB: Led by Countries, Powered by People
- (B) Find TB, Treat TB: Led by Countries, Powered by People
- (C) Zero TB Deaths: Led by Countries, Powered by People
- (D) Yes! We Can End TB: Led by Countries, Powered by People

Q4.

Read these statements:

- I. The Global Fund and Stop TB Partnership promote innovation in diagnostics.
- II. World TB Day marks the 1882 discovery of the TB bacterium.
- III. The WHO End TB targets for 2030 include a 50% reduction in TB deaths.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q5.

Read these statements:

- I. The Global Fund and Stop TB Partnership strengthen surveillance systems.
- II. The WHO End TB Strategy targets an 80% reduction in TB incidence by 2030.
- III. The WHO End TB Strategy runs only until 2030.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Under the WHO End TB Strategy, what is the target for the reduction in TB deaths by 2030?

- (A) 90%
- (B) 29%
- (C) 80%
- (D) 12%

Disease and Drug Resistance: MCQ

Tuberculosis is an infectious disease that has affected people for a long time and continues to be a concern for health systems in many countries. The illness can take more than one form, and medical reports describe those forms by the part of the body that is affected. Doctors therefore examine where the infection has settled before deciding how to respond. Treatment depends on medicines, and the choice of medicines depends on the case in hand. Some cases become difficult to manage, and public health officials watch those situations closely. Because of the seriousness of such cases, controlling the disease is treated as a shared task for governments, hospitals and communities rather than a matter for individual patients alone. Diagnosis made in good time matters, and treatment has to be completed as prescribed. Health workers play an important part in identifying cases early, supporting patients through their course of medicine and recording new cases so that the wider picture stays clear. Each stage of this work depends on good records, accurate testing and the steady cooperation of everyone involved in the response to the disease. A day of observance is held each year to raise awareness of the disease, and that day marks the discovery of its bacterial cause in 1882. Several initiatives have been launched in India to support the work, and some of them are monitored through digital platforms that track progress across the country.

Q1.

Which organism causes tuberculosis?

- (A) Plasmodium falciparum
- (B) Vibrio cholerae
- (C) Salmonella typhi
- (D) Mycobacterium tuberculosis

Q2.

Which form of TB affects the lungs and is highly contagious?

- (A) Extrapulmonary TB
- (B) Pulmonary TB
- (C) Latent TB
- (D) MDR-TB only

Q3.

Which of these is listed among the first-line drugs used to treat TB?

- (A) Ethambutol
- (B) Penicillin
- (C) Amoxicillin
- (D) Paracetamol

Q4.

Assertion (A): MDR-TB is resistant to first-line drugs.

Reason (R): MDR-TB requires second-line drugs, longer treatment and higher cost.

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (D) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Pulmonary TB	A. Resistant to Rifampicin and Isoniazid
II. Extrapulmonary TB	B. Bacterium that causes TB
III. MDR-TB	C. Affects the lungs and is highly contagious
IV. Mycobacterium tuberculosis	D. Affects organs outside the lungs

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C

Q6.

Read these statements:

- I. TB is an airborne, contagious infectious disease.
- II. Extrapulmonary TB is more contagious than pulmonary TB.
- III. MDR-TB requires second-line drugs for its treatment.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Read these statements:

- I. TB is caused by Mycobacterium tuberculosis.
- II. Ethambutol is a second-line drug for MDR-TB.
- III. TB cannot be cured even with timely diagnosis.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Brazil, Israel and Finland Ties

India's relations with partners across several continents moved forward in early 2026 through state visits, new agreements and participation in global forums. The most prominent visit was the state visit of the President of Brazil, which followed the Prime Minister's trip to Brazil in July 2025. The two countries reaffirmed their long-standing strategic partnership and agreed to deepen cooperation in trade, the digital economy and strategic sectors. Trade was another focus, and both sides set a long-term bilateral trade goal for the end of this decade. A joint declaration on digital partnership was adopted, covering digital infrastructure, artificial intelligence and emerging technologies. Their talks also covered energy transition and climate change, and the Prime Minister commended Brazil for hosting a major climate conference. Defence and space cooperation also featured in the discussions, which covered shared technology and innovation priorities. Relations with Israel were raised to a special strategic partnership level, reflecting closer cooperation in defence, technology and innovation. Separately, India and Finland agreed to elevate ties during a visit linked to the Raisina Dialogue, a forum launched in 2016 that discusses global governance, security and economics. Finally, the Takeshima and Dokdo islets remain a sovereignty dispute between Japan and South Korea, which protested a Japanese government-backed event in

Shimane Prefecture.

Q1.

Which satellite, launched by India in 2021, is Brazil's first fully indigenous Earth observation satellite?

- (A) Oceansat-1
- (B) NVS-01
- (C) Amazonia-2
- (D) Amazonia-1

Q2.

In which year did French whalers name the Liancourt Rocks?

- (A) 1905
- (B) 1849
- (C) 1951
- (D) 1954

Q3.

In which year was the Brazil-India Strategic Partnership established?

- (A) 2006
- (B) 1948
- (C) 2014
- (D) 2021

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Takeshima/Dokdo dispute is rooted in Japan's colonial rule over Korea.

Reason (R): Japan ruled Korea as a colony from 1910 to 1945.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Israel	A. Aims to double bilateral trade by 2030
II. South Korea	B. Holds 94% of niobium reserves
III. Finland	C. Permanent coastguard detachment on the islets since 1954
IV. Brazil	D. Up to 50,000 Indian workers over 5 years

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Examine the statements below:

- I. Japan claims it formally incorporated the islets in 1905 as terra nullius.
- II. The 1951 San Francisco Peace Treaty explicitly named the islets among the territories Japan was to return.
- III. Dokdo is South Korea's name for the islets and means Solitary Island.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) All of the above
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

1. The Indo-Finland Startup Corridor will connect India's Startup Mahakumbh with Finland's Slush.
 2. Japan's name for the islets, Takeshima, means Bamboo Island.
 3. India and Brazil signed a Critical Minerals MoU covering iron ore.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Immunisation and Water Programmes

Health and water programmes in India have increasingly focused on delivery to citizens. The Universal Immunisation Programme is among the largest public immunisation efforts in the world, and it provides free vaccines to infants, children and pregnant women. Intensified drives have targeted areas where immunisation coverage was low, and a later round focused on children and pregnant women who missed doses during the Covid-19 pandemic. Digital tracking of vaccination records is also supported, and the programme aims to reduce child mortality, morbidity and disability. Vaccination drives are planned for children up to two years of age. On water, the Jal Jeevan Mission was extended to the end of 2028 with a shift from building infrastructure to citizen-centric service delivery. Under the extension, the government aims to provide functional household tap connections to all rural households. Water supply systems will also receive unique service area identifiers, which will help track water supply and service delivery. The mission's standards also emphasise community ownership, transparency and accountability. On the environment side, India reports its biodiversity commitments under the Convention on Biological Diversity, and the Nagoya Protocol governs access and benefit-sharing for genetic resources. Reports to the convention are periodic, and each signatory must describe the measures it takes to implement the treaty.

Q1.

Which ministry launched Mission Indradhanush?

- (A) Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
- (B) Ministry of Jal Shakti
- (C) Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
- (D) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Q2.

In which year was the Jal Jeevan Mission launched?

- (A) 2014
- (B) 2017
- (C) 2019
- (D) 2021

Q3.

In which year was the Nagoya Protocol adopted?

- (A) 1992
- (B) 2010
- (C) 2014
- (D) 2017

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Jal Jeevan Mission was launched under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs.

Reason (R): Jal Jeevan Mission (Urban) is implemented by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) A is false but R is true
- (D) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Mission Indradhanush	A. Tap connections for 19.36 crore rural households
II. Intensified Mission Indradhanush 1.0	B. Launched on 25 December 2014
III. Jal Jeevan Mission	C. Full immunisation of more than 90% targeted by December 2018
IV. Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0	D. Water supply standard of 55 litres per capita per day

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

Q6.

Examine the statements below:

- I. Mission Indradhanush targets 12 vaccine-preventable diseases.
- II. India was certified polio-free in 2014.
- III. U-WIN is a digital platform for tracking land records.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) All of the above

Reserves, Security and Navigation

India's economic and security agenda in early 2026 touched on trade rules, reserve management, state finances, counter-terrorism, border infrastructure and satellite navigation. At the World Trade Organization, India opposed bringing an investment-related framework into the main trade system, even though many members supported it. Currency markets also drew attention, as India's foreign exchange reserves fell during the period. The reserves are held by the Reserve Bank of India, which uses them to stabilise the rupee and cushion external shocks. The reserves are governed by the Reserve Bank of India Act and the Foreign Exchange Management Act. Gold,

special drawing rights and the reserve tranche position with the IMF are also part of the reserves. The central bank sold dollars at times to manage volatility. On state finances, NITI Aayog released an annual fiscal health evaluation that benchmarks states on quality of expenditure, revenue mobilisation and debt. The index covers major states and north-eastern and Himalayan states, which are ranked separately. In security, the government released a national counter-terrorism policy that promises a zero-tolerance approach. In eastern Ladakh, an airfield drew attention for strengthening India's presence near the border. Satellite navigation also drew attention after a clock failure on one satellite weakened a regional system.

Q1.

Which organisation developed NavIC?

- (A) DRDO
- (B) CSIR
- (C) ISRO
- (D) BRO

Q2.

In which year was the Mudh-Nyoma Air Force Station built?

- (A) 1962
- (B) 1971
- (C) 1999
- (D) 2014

Q3.

After which conflict was NavIC initiated?

- (A) Indo-Pak War of 1947
- (B) Kargil War
- (C) Sino-Indian War
- (D) Indo-Pak War of 1971

Q4.

Assertion (A): India's forex reserves fell as the US dollar strengthened.

Reason (R): A stronger US dollar reduces the value of euro, yen and pound holdings in reserves.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Mudh-Nyoma Air Force Station	A. Requires at least four operational satellites
II. NavIC	B. Has seven pillars covering prevention to recovery
III. PRAHAAR	C. Relies on audited fiscal data from the CAG
IV. Fiscal Health Index 2026	D. Upgraded by the Border Roads Organisation under Project Himank

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q6.

Examine the statements below:

- I. The atomic clock was invented in 1955.
- II. NavIC consists of 7 satellites placed in geo-stationary and geo-synchronous orbits.
- III. Foreign currency assets are the smallest component of India's forex reserves.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) All of the above
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- 1. The IFD Agreement is a plurilateral agreement binding only on its signatories.
 - 2. The Fiscal Health Index 2026 covers FY 2023-24.
 - 3. The Mudh-Nyoma Air Force Station lies close to the northern bank of Pangong Tso.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

BAFTA Awards 2026: practice

The British Academy of Film and Television Arts, known by the short form BAFTA, is the body that presents the awards bearing its name. The awards honour achievement in film and television, and each ceremony recognises people whose work has been judged best in the relevant year. The booklet entry is written as a reference, giving the winners under separate headings rather than telling a single story.

The most recent ceremony covered in the booklet is the 2026 edition. It handed out awards for the top film prize, for direction, and for lead performances by actors and actresses, and the booklet lists the winners for each of these honours. Other winners from the same ceremony are gathered in the same list.

Indian films and performers also feature in the entry. The booklet describes a history of Indian recognition at the awards, with some wins coming from decades earlier and others from more recent years. Each milestone is presented as a separate point that names a person or film, the award won, and the year of that award.

The entry gives the organisation's context in a few short points. Its honours are split across several areas of screen work, and these points sit alongside the list of winners. Together they cover both the body itself and the awards it gives out.

Q1.

In which year was BAFTA established?

- (A) 1937
- (B) 1942
- (C) 1947
- (D) 1956

Q2.

In which city is BAFTA based?

- (A) London
- (B) Los Angeles
- (C) Manchester
- (D) Paris

Q3.

Which Indian actor became the first Indian to win a competitive BAFTA, in the Best Supporting Actress category?

- (A) Smita Patil
- (B) Shabana Azmi
- (C) Waheeda Rehman
- (D) Rohini Hattangadi

Q4.

Assertion (A): Boong became the first Indian film to win Best Children's and Family Film at the 2026 BAFTA Awards.

Reason (R): Boong is a Manipuri film directed by Lakshmipriya Devi.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Best Film	A. Hamnet
II. Best Director	B. Jessie Buckley
III. Outstanding British Film	C. Paul Thomas Anderson
IV. Best Leading Actress	D. One Battle After Another

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Statements:

- I. BAFTA is presented annually.
- II. BAFTA's categories cover Games and Children's & Family Content.
- III. Hamnet won Best Film at the 2026 BAFTA Awards.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I, II and III
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

How many of the following statements about BAFTA awards are correct?

- I. Asif Kapadia won Best British Film for *The Warrior* (2002).
 - II. A.R. Rahman won Best Film Music for *Slumdog Millionaire* (2009).
 - III. Rohini Hattangadi won Best Leading Actress for *Gandhi* (1983).
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

ASMITA Initiative: practice

ASMITA is an initiative in the sports sector, and the booklet's entry on it sits in the Miscellaneous section of the March 2026 Current Affairs booklet. The name is an acronym. Its letters stand for Achieving Sports Milestone by Inspiring Women Through Action, a phrase that signals the initiative's focus on women in sport. The initiative is presented in the booklet as a single entry.

The entry is short and is arranged under a few headings. These headings cover the basic facts about the initiative: when it began, the body that runs it, the name it carried before the current name, and the goals it sets out. Each heading is a separate point, so the entry works as a summary rather than a narrative.

The goals are described in two parts. The first part concerns the level at which the initiative works, and the second concerns the type of talent it looks for. Both parts appear together in the entry, so a reader sees the aims of the initiative in one place.

The entry sits alongside other items in the same section of the booklet. Those items include award-related entries, and the section as a whole covers a mix of topics under the Miscellaneous heading. The entry appears on the same page as the Oscars material.

Q1.

In which year was ASMITA launched?

- (A) 2019
- (B) 2020
- (C) 2021
- (D) 2023

Q2.

What was ASMITA earlier known as?

- (A) Khelo India Youth League
- (B) Khelo India Women's League
- (C) Women's Sports League
- (D) Rural Sports Mission

Q3.

Which ministry launched ASMITA?

- (A) Ministry of Women and Child Development
- (B) Ministry of Rural Development
- (C) Ministry of Tribal Affairs
- (D) Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports

Q4.

Assertion (A): ASMITA seeks to identify and nurture young sporting talent, especially from rural and tribal areas.

Reason (R): ASMITA seeks to promote sports participation among girls and women at the grassroots level.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Launch year	A. Khelo India Women's League
II. Launching body	B. Rural and tribal areas
III. Earlier name	C. 2021
IV. Focus of talent search	D. Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Statements:

- I. ASMITA was launched in 2021.
- II. ASMITA was earlier known as Khelo India Women's League.
- III. ASMITA's objectives do not include sports participation for women.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about ASMITA are correct?

- I. ASMITA was launched in 2021.
- II. ASMITA's objectives include identifying young talent from rural and tribal areas.
- III. ASMITA was earlier known as Khelo India Men's League.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Schemes and Electoral Options: MCQ Practice

The first concerns elections. A formal electoral option was introduced to give voters a way to express dissatisfaction with the candidates on offer, while strengthening democratic participation and voter freedom. The Supreme Court has also observed how this option has affected political parties over the past decade. The second item is a rooftop solar programme launched in 2024. It is described as the world's largest domestic rooftop solar initiative, and it aims to reach one crore households. Households that take part receive free electricity up to a set monthly limit, and the programme runs till FY 2026-27. The third item concerns rural water supply, which is covered

under Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0. The round-up notes that the initiative aims to improve governance, monitoring and service delivery in rural areas. The fourth item is a rapid transit system. The Prime Minister inaugurated India's first Namo Bharat Regional Rapid Transit System, a rail-based service in the National Capital Region. Its implementing agency is a joint venture of the Government of India and several state governments. Each entry in the round-up is set out with its own details, so the items can be read separately.

Q1.

Which ministry launched the Sujal Gaon ID?

- (A) Ministry of Jal Shakti
- (B) Ministry of New and Renewable Energy
- (C) Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports
- (D) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Q2.

What is the nodal ministry of the PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana?

- (A) Ministry of Jal Shakti
- (B) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- (C) Ministry of New and Renewable Energy
- (D) Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports

Q3.

What is the maximum speed of the Namo Bharat RRTS, in km/h?

- (A) 150
- (B) 180
- (C) 120
- (D) 200

Q4.

Assertion (A): NOTA allows voters to reject all candidates while being barred from taking part in the democratic process.

Reason (R): NOTA was introduced by the Supreme Court in PUCL vs Union of India (2013).

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Sujal Gaon ID	A. Option to reject all candidates in an election
II. Namo Bharat RRTS	B. Rooftop solar scheme with subsidy of up to 40% of installation cost
III. NOTA	C. Rail-based semi-high speed commuter system
IV. PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana	D. Digital identifier for rural piped water schemes

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Sujal Gaon ID is linked to a Sujalam Bharat ID.
- II. Namo Bharat RRTS is designed for inter-city regional travel within the NCR.
- III. The PM Surya Ghar scheme has the Ministry of Jal Shakti as its nodal ministry.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. NOTA was used in the 2013 Assembly Elections in Chhattisgarh, Mizoram, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Delhi.
- II. The PM Surya Ghar scheme provides a subsidy of up to 40% of installation cost.
- III. Namo Bharat RRTS was implemented by the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Trade and Energy Items: MCQ Practice

The first is a trade principle used among members of the WTO, and the round-up explains how it applies to trade concessions. The second is an agreement between India and the European Union, which concerns trade in services. The third is a major new oil refinery project in the United States, which the round-up describes as a large undertaking valued in the hundreds of billions. The fourth is a type of crude oil called light shale oil, which the round-up says is produced in several countries. Each item is described in its own short entry, and the round-up gives details for each one. The refinery entry names a company as a key partner and identifies the company that developed the project. Light shale oil is described in terms of its physical features and the kind of rock formations in which it is trapped. The round-up treats these items separately, so each entry can be read on its own. The round-up gives the refinery's location within Texas and points to a port in the south of the state as part of the project. For light shale oil, the entry also lists the countries where it is produced, which allows readers to see its global spread.

Q1.

Which Indian company was announced as a key partner in the \$300 billion Texas Oil Refinery Project?

- (A) Tata Steel
- (B) Reliance Industries Limited
- (C) Bharat Forge
- (D) Adani Ports

Q2.

Which company developed the Texas refinery project?

- (A) Texas Refining Consortium
- (B) Permian Energy Group
- (C) Brownsville Port Authority
- (D) America First Refining

Q3.

What is the sulphur content of light shale oil, as described in the booklet?

- (A) Low
- (B) High
- (C) Medium
- (D) Very high

Q4.

Assertion (A): Light shale oil has a high hydrogen-to-carbon ratio.

Reason (R): Light shale oil is found mainly in deep offshore fields.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Light shale oil	A. Company announced as key partner in the Texas refinery project
II. Most Favoured Nation	B. Largest oil-producing region in the USA
III. Permian Basin	C. Equal treatment of all WTO members in trade concessions
IV. Reliance Industries Limited	D. Low-density crude trapped in low-permeability shale or tight sandstone

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

I. Light shale oil is also known as light tight oil.

II. India and the EU agreed to grant MFN status in trade in services for 5 years.

III. The Texas refinery is located at the Port of Brownsville in North Texas.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

I. MFN ensures non-discriminatory global trade.

II. The Texas refinery is located in the Permian Basin.

III. Reliance Industries Limited developed the Texas refinery.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Sports and Border Trade: MCQ Practice

The first concerns a sports event for tribal communities, which is scheduled to take place in 2026. The event is designed to bring tribal sporting talent into the national sports ecosystem while preserving traditional indigenous games. It is held under a national sports scheme, which aims to strengthen India's sports ecosystem, and a mascot has been chosen to represent the pride, bravery and cultural identity of tribal communities. The round-up lists the sports involved and the bodies that organise the event. The second entry concerns a Himalayan border pass. The round-up describes it as the first Indian border post for trade with China, and the pass lies in a region of Uttarakhand. The round-up says India is set to resume border trade with China through this pass. An alternate route through Nathu La Pass is mentioned, while a route through Dharchula is under repair. The sports entry and the border entry are both presented as current news from March 2026, and each has its own short paragraph and key points. The round-up introduces both entries with short headings in the same format as other items.

Q1.

Which two sports are included in the Khelo India Tribal Games?

- (A) Mallakhamb and Kabaddi
- (B) Kabaddi and Archery
- (C) Mallakhamb and Wrestling
- (D) Kho-Kho and Kabaddi

Q2.

After a COVID-induced suspension of how many years is India set to resume border trade via Lipulekh Pass?

- (A) Two
- (B) Four
- (C) Six
- (D) Eight

Q3.

Lipulekh Pass is situated in which region of Uttarakhand?

- (A) Garhwal
- (B) Kumaon
- (C) Malwa
- (D) Bundelkhand

Q4.

Assertion (A): Lipulekh Pass is set to reopen for border trade with Nepal.

Reason (R): Lipulekh Pass is a key route for the Kailash Mansarovar Yatra.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Khelo India Scheme	A. Mascot of the Tribal Games
II. Morveer	B. Launched in 2016-17 by the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports
III. Lipulekh Pass	C. Host state of the first Khelo India Tribal Games
IV. Chhattisgarh	D. Tri-junction of India, Nepal and China

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Khelo India Scheme was launched in 2016-17 by the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports.
- II. The Sports Authority of India is among the organising bodies of the Tribal Games.
- III. Morveer is the mascot representing the cultural identity of the Lipulekh Pass region.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Chhattisgarh is set to host the first Khelo India Tribal Games.
- II. Morveer is the mascot of the Khelo India Scheme.
- III. Kabaddi is one of the sports included in the Tribal Games.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Type-in-the-answer passages

Hormuz and India's Energy Exposure

The Strait of Hormuz is a narrow waterway that connects the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and, beyond it, to the Arabian Sea. It is the only maritime outlet for the oil and gas exports of the Persian Gulf, which makes it one of the most critical energy chokepoints in the world. Because so much energy passes through it, any threat to shipping in the strait is watched closely by markets. Traders often add a risk premium when disruption seems possible, and this speculative demand can push prices up before any actual supply is lost. If the conflict spreads to the Red Sea or the Suez Canal, shipping routes would be affected, transit times would increase and freight costs would rise. Supply bottlenecks could follow.

For a large importer like India, such shocks reach the economy in several ways. Higher crude prices widen the import bill, add pressure on the rupee and feed into inflation in transport, fertilisers and manufacturing. The government may absorb part of the shock through excise duty

cuts, which can worsen the fiscal deficit. Fuel subsidies for LPG and urea may also rise. Energy-intensive industries face higher input costs and shrinking margins, while a wider current account deficit adds to the strain on the economy.

Q1.

Which peninsula of Oman lies to the south of the Strait of Hormuz?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What share of global oil supply transits the Strait of Hormuz? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What fraction of global LNG trade transits the Strait of Hormuz?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What percentage of India's crude oil requirement does India import? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q5.

By roughly how many billion dollars a year does India's import bill rise for each \$1 rise in oil price?

Answer: _____

Q6.

What percentage of India's crude oil imports pass through the Strait of Hormuz? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which country supplies nearly half of India's LNG imports?

Answer: _____

India and Afghanistan ties

India's relationship with Afghanistan rests on historical, cultural and developmental foundations. Gandhara, a region that is part of modern-day Afghanistan, was one of the Mahajanapadas of the Vedic Age, and the Bamiyan Buddhas reflect the influence of Buddhism in the country. Afghanistan is also strategically important, because it acts as a crossroad between South Asia and Central Asia as well as between South Asia and the Middle East. Over the years, India has backed projects that support Afghanistan's energy, agriculture and drinking water needs, as well as its democratic institutions. Dams, roads and public buildings are among the projects India has built or helped build. One gas pipeline would carry natural gas from Turkmenistan through Afghanistan and Pakistan to India, while another highway gives Afghanistan a route to a port in Iran that bypasses Pakistan. India has also engaged the Taliban regime at a senior diplomatic level. Afghanistan's position on the border differs, since it does not officially recognise the Durand Line. Repeated closures of the Torkham crossing have also hurt Afghan trade and pushed Kabul toward Iranian routes, which shows how trade and border policy are linked. Taken together, India's engagement covers history, development and trade.

Q1.

What is the name of the gas pipeline project that carries natural gas from Turkmenistan through Afghanistan and Pakistan to India?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the length of the TAPI gas pipeline (in km)?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which Afghan province is the Salma Dam (Afghan-India Friendship Dam) located?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the Afghan Parliament Building, built by India, inaugurated?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Afghan Acting Foreign Minister met India's Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri in Dubai?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which Iranian port does the Zaranj-Delaram Highway connect Afghanistan to?

Answer: _____

Border and Trade Recall

India and Nepal share one of the most open and historically rooted relationships in the region. Nepal lies in the Himalayas as a buffer between India and China, and its border touches several Indian states, including Sikkim, West Bengal and Bihar. The 1950 Treaty of Peace and Friendship forms the foundation of bilateral relations, although Nepal now considers it outdated and unequal. Trade between the two countries is large, and India is Nepal's largest trade and investment partner. Connectivity projects include a cross-border petroleum pipeline and a cross-border rail line, which are meant to strengthen economic links. Cooperation also extends to power trade, with a trilateral arrangement that allows Nepal to supply electricity to a third country through Indian territory. Boundary questions remain unsettled, especially in the western sector. A treaty signed after a war between Nepal and the British East India Company set the boundaries, but different maps issued over time created confusion about the source of a river. Several water-sharing agreements from earlier decades remain stalled, which delays important joint projects on rivers that flow between the two countries. Both countries are members of regional groupings such as SAARC and BIMSTEC. Nepal's hill districts have long supplied recruits to Indian Gorkha regiments.

Q1.

What is the length of the India-Nepal border (in km)?

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many Indian states share a boundary with Nepal?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the Kosi Agreement between India and Nepal signed?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which river's western boundary was defined by the Treaty of Sugauli (name the river)?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What was the value of India-Nepal bilateral trade in FY 2024-25 (in US\$ billion)?

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many MW of power will Nepal supply to Bangladesh via India under the first trilateral power trade (in MW)?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which multipurpose project on the Mahakali river is delayed because of stalled agreements?

Answer: _____

Diplomatic Strain Recall

Relations between India and Canada came under strain after a series of disputes. Diplomatic ties between the two countries had been in place since 1947, so the strain was felt in a long-established relationship. Canada's Prime Minister alleged a possible link between Indian agents and the killing of a Sikh separatist leader, Hardeep Singh Nijjar. The disagreement deepened when both countries expelled diplomats and froze consular services, which made it harder for citizens to access official help. Routine services for citizens became harder to obtain for a time. India viewed Canada's tolerance of separatist groups as a threat to its territorial integrity, and this added to the mistrust between the two governments. The rifts also reached the economy. Trade negotiations were halted, bilateral trade slowed and uncertainty was created for Canadian investments in India. Business planning became harder because of the uncertainty around trade ties and new investment in the region. Students and job applicants felt the impact as visa processing for Indians became slower. The standoff was also seen as a risk to India's standing in major global forums and to its ties with some of Canada's closest partners. Taken together, these developments show how a single dispute can spread into trade, visas and wider diplomacy.

Q1.

In which year was Hardeep Singh Nijjar killed? (in year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which Canadian Prime Minister alleged a potential link between Indian agents and the killing? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Delays in Canadian visa processing for Indians are linked to reduced Canadian what? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Canada's tolerance of which separatist groups does India see as a threat to its territorial integrity? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which trade agreement's negotiations were stalled by the diplomatic rifts? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q6.

The standoff may complicate relations with which group of allies? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q7.

The standoff may harm India's reputation in which grouping? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Integration and early reorganisation

At the time of independence, India had two categories of political units: British Provinces and Princely States. The settlement of 1947 created two independent dominions, India and Pakistan, and gave the Princely States three options: joining India, joining Pakistan or remaining independent. Most Princely States within India's geographical boundaries joined India, while a few refused to do so. Those that refused were later integrated with India, but not all of them through the same route. The process shows how political boundaries were reshaped in the years after independence. The Constitution of 1950 classified the States and Territories of the Indian Union into four parts. The first part covered the erstwhile Governor's Provinces of British India, and the second covered erstwhile Princely States that had legislatures. The third part covered erstwhile Chief Commissioner's Provinces along with some Princely States. The Andaman and Nicobar Islands formed a separate fourth category by themselves. The debate on reorganising States on the basis of language began soon after independence. In June 1948 the government appointed a commission under SK Dhar to examine the issue, and its recommendations placed administrative convenience ahead of language. A Congress committee later rejected language as the basis for reorganisation. The creation of a new State in 1953 then intensified the demand for language-based States, and the government appointed a three-member commission to re-examine the whole question.

Q1.

Which Act of 1947 created the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan? (name of the Act)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Of the 552 Princely States situated within India's geographical boundaries at independence, how many joined India? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Princely State was integrated with India by means of a referendum? (name of the State)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Through which instrument was Kashmir integrated with India? (name of the instrument)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Under the 1950 Constitution, how many erstwhile Governor's Provinces of British India were placed in Part A? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which committee, formed by Congress in December 1948 and consisting of Nehru, Patel and Pattabhi Sitaramayya, is popularly known by a three-letter name? (give the name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Who chaired the three-member States Reorganisation Commission that re-examined the linguistic question? (name)

Answer: _____

Mandal Commission and Indra Sawhney: numbers

After independence, the government recognised that some communities beyond the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes remained socially and educationally backward. A later Backward Classes Commission was set up under a constitutional provision that allows the state to investigate the conditions of such classes and suggest measures for their advancement. Its work involved studying the social standing of these communities across the country before recommending remedies.

The Commission's central recommendation concerned reservation in government jobs for backward communities. The government of the time later implemented this recommendation, and the decision reserved 27% of government jobs for these groups.

In a later judgement, the Supreme Court examined the validity of the reservation. It upheld the scheme with conditions. These included a limit on the total reserved share, a bar on reservation in promotions, and a requirement that advanced members of the class be excluded. The Court also held that the carry-forward rule for backlog vacancies could remain valid, and it called for a permanent statutory body to handle complaints about inclusion in the list.

Q1.

Under which Article of the Constitution was the second Backward Classes Commission set up? (give the number only)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did this commission submit its report?

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many castes did the commission identify as socially and educationally backward?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What percentage of government jobs did the commission recommend for OBCs? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Prime Minister's government appointed the commission in 1979?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In 1991, what percentage of jobs was reserved for economically backward sections of higher castes not covered by any existing scheme? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under the Indra Sawhney judgement, what was the ceiling on total reservation? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Legal and welfare milestones: typed answers

The legal status of gender and sexual minorities in India has changed through a sequence of court judgments, a statute and government initiatives. LGBTQ+ is a broad category covering people who identify in different ways, and the terminology used varies with historical, cultural and social contexts. Discrimination can be based on sexual orientation, gender expression, gender identity or

sex characteristics. Over the years the Supreme Court has been asked to decide several questions about these rights, including the status of relations between consenting adults and whether marriage between people of the same sex can be legally recognised. Parliament has also enacted a law meant to protect the rights of transgender persons and provide for their welfare. Alongside legal change, the government has launched support programmes that offer rehabilitation, identity documents, shelter and skill training. Countries across the world have taken different paths on these questions, and their rights records are compared through indices. Understanding the sequence of cases, statutes and schemes helps place the current debate on the Amendment Bill in context. Such schemes are designed to support people who face social exclusion, and the benefits they offer are meant to reach communities that have historically been marginalised. A useful way to study this topic is to connect each legal development with the rights it recognised and the practical support that followed it.

Q1.

In which year did the Supreme Court strike down Section 377 in Navtej Singh Johar vs Union of India? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which section of the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019 does the Amendment Bill 2026 propose to omit? (section number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which scheme provides comprehensive rehabilitation and medical cover for marginalised individuals, including transgender persons? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Garima Greh shelter homes are provided by the government to offer safe spaces to transgender persons in what condition? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act enacted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What minimum rank must nominated members of the National Council for Transgender Persons hold under the Amendment Bill? (one word)

Answer: _____

Data and Methods Check

Official statistics are only as good as the information fed into them. Modern statistical systems combine several sources to improve coverage of the informal sector. Tax collections on goods and services offer a timely view of business activity, while registrations of motor vehicles reflect demand and mobility. Financial management systems record government spending and receipts, which helps in measuring public sector activity. Labour surveys provide information on employment, including work that does not follow a conventional pattern. Such sources help capture household enterprises and digital activity that are hard to observe directly. Measurement also depends on how prices are handled. When output is converted into real terms, a careful price adjustment gives a more accurate picture of value added across the economy. Statisticians must also decide who is counted within the economy, and newer estimates aim to include workers who earn income in unconventional ways. Better coverage does not change the underlying economy, but

it reduces the risk that real activity goes unrecorded. Users of these statistics should therefore read revised figures alongside the notes that explain changes in methodology.

Q1.

Which deflation method adjusts both output prices and input prices when measuring real value addition? (name the method)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which survey covering unincorporated sector enterprises was added as a data source? (give the full name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Apart from the Old Pension Scheme, which pension system is now included in GDP government sector accounts? (give the full name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year were India's first National Income Estimates published? (in year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Union ministry released the New National Accounts Series? (give the name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Name the two sectors whose real value addition is measured more accurately under the new method. (name both)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What was the earlier base year before the 2026 revision? (in year range)

Answer: _____

Rankings and reading the report

A global happiness report places countries in a single ranking, and each new edition draws attention to where nations stand. The scores come from survey responses in which people rate their own lives on a scale from zero to ten. Because scores change from year to year, a country's position can rise or fall between editions, even when the difference looks small.

The report considers several areas, including economic output, community support, healthy life expectancy, freedom and generosity. Some countries perform strongly on one area and less well on another. Regional and group comparisons are also common. Emerging economies that form a bloc are often compared with each other, and neighbouring countries are compared to show how a nation performs within its own region. Social trust and governance quality are also highlighted as important features of a society.

Attention has also turned to young people. Findings suggest that age and digital habits are both connected with life satisfaction. Researchers caution that the link is not simple. In one setting, the same technology may help with education and connectivity, while in another it may create stress and anxiety. Patterns also vary by age group, so experiences can differ between generations. Such differences show that the picture is complex.

Q1.

What is India's rank in the World Happiness Report 2026? (a number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which country ranked lowest, at 147th, in the World Happiness Report 2026?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Since which year has the World Happiness Report been published annually? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which country rose from 23rd to 4th place in the 2026 report? (country)

Answer: _____

Q5.

For how many consecutive years has Finland ranked first, as of 2026? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Youth using social media for less than how many hours a day reported the best well-being? (in hours)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which natural event does the International Day of Happiness coincide with? (two words)

Answer: _____

India's arms imports quiz

India is one of the world's major buyers of defence equipment, and its purchases shape both its military capability and its relationships with foreign suppliers. In the most recent SIPRI assessment, covering 2021 to 2025, India kept a high position among the world's arms importers. However, its total arms imports during this period were lower than in the earlier phase, a change linked to a growing push for domestic production. Over the past several years, the government has focused on building a stronger defence manufacturing base at home. Procurement policy was revised to prioritise Indian-made products over foreign purchases, which signals a clear preference for local industry. To support this shift, industrial corridors have been created in certain states to bring together manufacturers and suppliers. Foreign investment is also allowed in the defence sector through both automatic and government routes, while a dedicated initiative supports start-ups and small firms working on innovation. Taken together, these steps aim to reduce dependence on imported weapons and to turn India into a larger producer and exporter of defence equipment. The way procurement rules are designed determines how much equipment is sourced from abroad and how much is built locally. Industry players are being encouraged to take on more of the manufacturing work, which supports the aim of building a broader defence industrial base.

Q1.

What was India's share (in per cent) of global arms imports during 2021-25?

Answer: _____

Q2.

By how many per cent did India's overall arms imports decline during 2021-25?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which country was the largest supplier to India's arms imports during 2021-25?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which country was the second-largest supplier to India's arms imports during 2021-25?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What was India's defence production value in 2024-25 (in Rs lakh crore)?

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the target for India's defence exports in 2029 (in Rs crore)?

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was the Defence Acquisition Procedure that prioritises Indian-made products introduced?

Answer: _____

Medal tally and participation TITA practice

Medal tables are the standard way of comparing how countries performed at the Olympic Games, because they add up the medals won by each nation across all sports. The Milano Cortina 2026 Winter Olympics featured 16 winter sports, and the final table recorded the results of several nations in those events. Italy, as the host nation, appears in the same table with its own medal total. India's presence at the Winter Games was small. The country fielded a limited number of athletes, who competed in alpine skiing and cross-country skiing, and the contingent did not win any medal. India first participated at the Olympic Games in 1900, and it first sent a team to the Summer Games in 1920. The country has also competed at the Winter Olympic Games held at Innsbruck, Austria, in 1964. The International Olympic Committee is headquartered in Lausanne, Switzerland, and the Indian Olympic Association has its headquarters in New Delhi. At the Paris Olympics, India won 6 medals and finished 71st in the medal tally. At Paris, Manu Bhaker won bronze in the Women's 10 Metre Air Pistol event. Aman Sehrawat, who won an individual bronze at the Paris Summer Olympics, is the youngest Indian to win an individual Olympic medal.

Q1.

Which country topped the final medal table at the 2026 Winter Olympics? (name of country)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many gold medals did Norway win at the 2026 Winter Olympics? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many medals did the USA win at the 2026 Winter Olympics? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many gold medals did Italy win at the 2026 Winter Olympics? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many athletes did India field at the 2026 Winter Olympics? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Who was India's torchbearer at the Milano Cortina 2026 Winter Olympics? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

How many medals did the Netherlands win at the 2026 Winter Olympics? (number)

Answer: _____

India response check

India has built a layered response to tuberculosis that combines national planning, direct support for patients and digital tools for monitoring. The national strategy is a roadmap to eliminate the disease, and its timeline is set to finish ahead of the global schedule. Its goals include steep reductions in incidence and in deaths, measured against the baseline set for the plan. Patients receive support as well as treatment. Under a direct benefit transfer scheme, every person registered for treatment receives a monthly amount meant for nutrition. Citizens and organisations can also take part. Individuals, non-governmental organisations and corporates are encouraged to support patients through a community-driven model. Diagnosis has also improved. A molecular test based on the polymerase chain reaction principle is now part of the toolkit, helping health workers detect the disease. Urban areas receive focused attention because they can contain hotspots where transmission is concentrated. Local interventions are designed to respond to such pockets rather than treating the whole city uniformly. Such local work is carried out under the separately launched TB Mukh Urban Ward Initiative. Progress is visible in the national figures, which show that the disease rate has fallen in recent years. Officials use digital platforms to monitor the programme, raise public awareness and invite citizen participation.

Q1.

Name the 100 Days Intensified Campaign launched in India to accelerate TB elimination.

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the monthly nutritional support under the Ni-Kshay Poshan Yojana? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q3.

By how many years does India's National Strategic Plan for TB Elimination aim to eliminate TB ahead of global timelines? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What percentage reduction in TB incidence does India's National Strategic Plan target by 2025? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which PCR-based molecular test is listed among India's modern TB testing tools? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

By what percentage did India's TB incidence rate fall between 2015 and 2024? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

History and personalities: typed answer practice

Several episodes of India's freedom struggle were recalled in recent public events, highlighting the sacrifices of young revolutionaries and national leaders. Shaheed Diwas is observed every year to honour Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev Thapar and Shivaram Hari Rajguru, who were executed in the Lahore Central Jail. Their activities were linked to the Lahore Conspiracy Case, which followed the fatal injury of Lala Lajpat Rai during a protest against the Simon Commission. Mahatma Gandhi's protest against the colonial salt monopoly is another landmark. He led a march from the Sabarmati Ashram in Ahmedabad to the coastal village of Dandi in Gujarat, where he produced salt from seawater to defy the salt law. The march was triggered after the Viceroy rejected Gandhi's eleven-point demands, which included the abolition of the salt tax. Chakravarti Rajagopalachari, popularly known as Rajaji, was another key figure of this era. He led the Vedaranyam salt march in South India and later proposed a compromise formula to prevent the partition of the country. After independence he served as Governor-General, and he later founded the Swatantra Party. In sports, the government launched a nationwide grassroots athletics league to encourage women's participation. The league is linked to the Khelo India scheme and aims to identify talent from rural, tribal and school levels across age groups.

Q1.

In which year did the Dandi March (Salt Satyagraha) begin? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

On which day of March is Shaheed Diwas observed? (day of the month)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year did the British colonial government enact the Salt Act? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Viceroy of India rejected Gandhi's eleven-point demands before the Dandi March? (surname)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did C. Rajagopalachari propose the C.R. Formula? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which Indian state is Thorapalli, the birthplace of Rajaji, located? (name of state)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Across how many locations was the ASMITA Athletics League launched? (number)

Answer: _____

Literary Awards Check

India honours its writers through several prestigious literary awards. Among these, the Jnanpith Award is regarded as one of the country's oldest and highest literary honours, and it is often compared to a Nobel Prize for Indian literature. The award is given only to Indian authors for outstanding contributions to literature, and it recognises lifetime work rather than a single book. It is not awarded posthumously. The works considered can be in any of the languages listed in the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution, as well as English. The award is presented by Bharatiya Jnanpith. Another major honour is the Sahitya Akademi Award, which recognises outstanding

literary works and is given to Indian citizens across many languages. The Sahitya Akademi announced its 2025 awards to 24 authors for literary excellence in different languages and genres, from novels to memoirs. Together, these awards highlight the range of literature produced in India and give writers national recognition for their contribution to Indian letters. The Jnanpith is awarded for a writer's overall body of work rather than one book or one year of writing, so each recognition reflects sustained literary effort. Awards of this kind also help readers discover writing in many languages, from the languages of the Eighth Schedule to English, and they show how literature in India is shared across regions and communities.

Q1.

In which year was the Jnanpith Award instituted?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did Ashapoorna Devi become the first woman recipient of the Jnanpith Award?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Who was the first English-language winner of the Jnanpith Award? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which language did G. Sankara Kurup, the first Jnanpith recipient in 1965, write? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Who established the Jnanpith along with his wife Rama Jain? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the title of Navtej Sarna's English novel that was honoured in the Sahitya Akademi Awards 2025?

Answer: _____

Q7.

How many authors were honoured in the Sahitya Akademi Awards 2025? (in number)

Answer: _____

Environment and Space Recall

Environmental and scientific initiatives featured prominently in March 2026. The National Highways Authority of India released the first annual report of its National Highways Green Cover Index for 2025-26. The assessment surveyed 30,000 km of National Highways across 24 States, using high-resolution satellite imagery from Resourcesat-2 and Resourcesat-2A. The index was prepared with the National Remote Sensing Centre of ISRO. The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change also launched Him-CONNECT at the World Sustainable Development Summit, aiming to connect scientific research with real-world implementation in the Himalayan region. In wildlife conservation, nine cheetahs from Botswana arrived at Kuno National Park under Project Cheetah. The project is India's flagship wildlife conservation initiative and operates under the umbrella of Project Tiger. The cheetah was a species that had become officially extinct in India, so the project aims to reintroduce it. In space news, NASA confirmed that asteroid 2024 YR4 will not hit the Moon, after updated observations from the James Webb Space Telescope. The asteroid belongs to the Apollo group of near-Earth asteroids, whose orbits cross Earth's orbit. Taken together, these items show how monitoring, research and conservation work side by side.

Q1.

In which year were cheetahs officially declared extinct in India? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which state recorded the highest highway green cover, at 53.16 per cent, in the National Highways Green Cover Index 2025-26? (name of state)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which body implements Project Cheetah? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which observatory in Chile discovered asteroid 2024 YR4? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Under which mission was Him-CONNECT developed? (name of mission)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What type of asteroid is 2024 YR4 classified as? (in two words)

Answer: _____

Q7.

How many cheetahs were brought from Namibia to India in 2022? (number)

Answer: _____

Nuclear Deal and Its Collapse

The nuclear dispute between Iran and Western powers had shaped regional politics for years. A deal signed in 2015 placed limits on Iran's nuclear activity in exchange for sanctions relief. Later, the United States left that agreement on its own and restored sanctions, and Iran began to go beyond the limits it had accepted.

Negotiations later took place in Geneva, but they broke down after Washington demanded major changes to Iran's nuclear facilities and a permanent halt to uranium enrichment. Iran's wider regional role also worried its rivals, including a network of allied armed groups spread across the Middle East.

When talks failed, the United States and Israel carried out joint strikes on Iran. The attacks used heavy bombers and targeted fortified sites. Iran responded with missiles and drones aimed at Israeli and American military targets, and the attacks reached several Gulf states. The escalation raised concerns about a wider war in West Asia and about the security of shipping routes in the region.

Q1.

In which year did the United States withdraw unilaterally from the JCPOA?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What uranium enrichment limit did Iran agree to under the JCPOA? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the nickname of the US B-1B Lancer bomber deployed in Operation Epic Fury?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Persian Gulf island, about 50 km off Iran's coast, handles nearly 90% of Iran's crude oil exports?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Iran used a solid-fuel missile in strikes on Israeli and US bases that is nicknamed the 'Dancing Missile'. What is its name?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Iranian missiles struck near which heavily protected nuclear research centre?

Answer: _____

Q7.

What was the name of Iran's retaliatory operation against US and Israeli targets?

Answer: _____

Power and Selection of the Leader

Iran's Supreme Leader sits at the top of the country's political system and holds ultimate authority over its political, military and religious institutions. The office is head of state in law and commands the armed forces. Its holder also oversees national security and foreign policy, and has influence over the vetting of candidates for elections.

The office rests on a religious-political idea: that a senior Islamic jurist should hold ultimate political authority in an Islamic state. The idea was given institutional form after the 1979 revolution, when the first holder of the office took power.

The leader is chosen by a clerical body that is elected by the public. That body also monitors the leader's performance. A 1989 constitutional amendment changed the rules for choosing the office's holder, and the office has now passed to a new leader after the death of its predecessor.

Q1.

Who was named Iran's third Supreme Leader after Ali Khamenei's assassination?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the name of the doctrine from which the Supreme Leader's authority derives, based on the guardianship of the Islamic jurist?

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many members does the Assembly of Experts have? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the name of the clerical body that chooses Iran's Supreme Leader?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the term for the highest-ranking Shia clerical authority, a rank the Supreme Leader was once required to hold?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Along with the armed forces, which force does the Supreme Leader command?

Answer: _____

Oil Routes and Reserves

A large part of that supply moves through the Strait of Hormuz, the waterway that links the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman. Tensions in West Asia therefore pose a direct risk to India's energy supply. Rising prices are a second concern. Global crude oil prices have climbed sharply during the crisis, which increases the cost of India's oil import bill. Higher costs then feed into transport, fertiliser, manufacturing and logistics, adding pressure on inflation and on the government's finances, since it may absorb part of the price shock through tax cuts. India's strategic petroleum reserve is designed to act as a buffer against global oil shocks and to help stabilise prices. Reserves of this kind are meant to ensure that industry and defence receive uninterrupted fuel. Many governments hold reserves covering a set period of net oil imports, and India's own programme is part of its response to the current instability.

Q1.

What is the total capacity of India's Strategic Petroleum Reserve? (in million tonnes)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Under which ministry does the Indian Strategic Petroleum Reserves Limited, which manages the SPR, operate?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the global norm for net oil import reserves? (in days)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which Indian state is Rajkot, a proposed SPR site, located?

Answer: _____

Q5.

India is the largest exporter of which type of rice?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which two hydrocarbons make up LPG?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Act of 1955 was invoked to ensure LPG availability during the crisis?

Answer: _____

Border Strains and Military Escalation

Pakistan and Afghanistan have been in dispute for a long time, and the current fighting followed a series of incidents. Pakistan launched an operation against Afghan military bases. In response, Afghanistan carried out airstrikes on Pakistani targets, which showed that the conflict had moved

beyond the border.

Several issues lie behind the confrontation. The Afghan Taliban is accused of sheltering a militant group that attacks Pakistan, and the two sides also disagree over the border between them. Pakistan regards the Durand Line as a permanent international boundary, while Afghan governments have historically disputed its legitimacy.

Trade has been another source of strain. Crossings on the border have been shut more than once, and these closures have damaged Afghan trade. The disruption pushed the Afghan government to look for other routes, and it added to the mistrust between the two countries.

Pakistan's own policy has also been affected. For a long time it relied on a doctrine that treated Afghanistan as a source of leverage. The Taliban's outreach to India has weakened that approach.

Q1.

Which Pakistani airbase in Rawalpindi was targeted by Afghan airstrikes?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Afghan airstrikes also hit the 12th Division HQ; in which Pakistani city is that headquarters located?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What does the abbreviation TTP stand for?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the length of the Durand Line, in km?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which doctrine, which treated Afghanistan as a source of leverage, has been eroded by the Taliban's outreach to India?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year did Pakistan inherit the Durand Line as a border after independence?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Repeated closures of the Torkham crossing pushed which Afghan capital toward Iranian trade routes?

Answer: _____

Implications of the Conflict for India

The war between Pakistan and Afghanistan carries implications for India, which the booklet groups under a heading of its own. The effects are described for several areas, including India's western border, its security environment and its trade links.

Afghanistan has been through many changes of government. Its monarchy ended in 1973, and a communist government backed by the Soviet Union followed. After the US withdrawal in August 2021, the Taliban regained full control of the country.

Pakistan first welcomed that development, expecting strategic alignment. However, tensions resurfaced as cross-border militancy continued. Border crossings have also been shut more than once, and these closures have hurt Afghan trade.

The military phase began when Pakistan launched an operation against Afghan military bases. Afghanistan replied with airstrikes on Pakistani targets, and the confrontation became a direct military one. The booklet presents these events as the background to its discussion of what the conflict means for India.

Q1.

What does the abbreviation INSTC stand for?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What does the abbreviation ISIS-K stand for?

Answer: _____

Q3.

A full-scale conflict risks an inflow of which people onto India's borders?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Escalation on the western border may reduce Pakistan's infiltration pressure along which line?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What did India do to Pakistan's attacks on Afghanistan? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

India reaffirmed Afghanistan's sovereignty and territorial integrity, and also which other principle?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Afghanistan is described as a crossroad between South Asia and Central Asia, and between South Asia and which other region?

Answer: _____

Nepal's Parties and Constitution

Nepal's political life rests on a written constitution that sets out how power is divided among the country's institutions. The constitutional framework covers the type of government, the offices of President and Prime Minister, the structure of Parliament and the electoral system. The President acts as the ceremonial head of state, while the Prime Minister leads the government.

Parliament has two houses, and elections to it use more than one method of choosing representatives. Several parties have shaped Nepal's public life for decades. The Nepali Congress, the CPN-UML and the CPN-Maoist Centre are among the best-known parties, and each has been led by prominent figures over time. Pushpa Kamal Dahal, widely known as Prachanda, once served as Prime Minister and is now the present leader of the CPN-Maoist Centre.

Nepal has historically struggled with political instability. Governments have changed often since the return of democracy, and the country's political system has passed through several distinct phases over the decades. These developments form the background to the country's present

politics. A people's movement in 1990 ended the partyless Panchayat system and made the monarchy ceremonial. Nepal's politics has moved through several phases, including a monarchy, the Panchayat system and the return of democracy.

Q1.

Which electoral method allocates seats according to each party's share of the vote?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Pushpa Kamal Dahal (Prachanda) had been Prime Minister since which year?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the CPN-UML founded?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the Constitution of Nepal adopted?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Since the restoration of democracy in 1990, no Nepali government has completed what?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which house of Nepal's Parliament has 275 members?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Who succeeded Pushpa Kamal Dahal (Prachanda) as Prime Minister?

Answer: _____

India-Nepal Treaty and Ties

India and Nepal share a porous border and a relationship built on history, culture and trade. Nepal acts as a Himalayan buffer state between India and another large neighbour, and India is Nepal's largest trade partner. Both countries are founding members of regional groupings in South Asia.

The relationship rests on a treaty of peace and friendship that was signed after India's independence. It granted citizens of each country reciprocal rights of residence, trade and free movement. Nepal has since described that treaty as outdated and unequal, and this has created some diplomatic friction.

Border questions remain sensitive, and disagreements persist at several points along the frontier. Economic and infrastructure cooperation is also important, including cross-border rail and power projects. Changes in Nepal's political landscape can alter how the two governments engage with one another. Joint military exercises, such as Surya Kiran, are part of defence cooperation. The two countries also share a tradition of cultural and religious ties, including the Ramayana and the Buddha's birthplace at Lumbini. The Indian Army's Gorkha regiments are partly recruited from Nepal's hill districts. Sister-city arrangements also link Lumbini and Bodhgaya, and Janakpur and Ayodhya. The porous frontier also raises concerns about illegal migration and security.

Q1.

In which year was the India-Nepal treaty that RSP proposes to revisit signed?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which Indian policy might RSP's technocratic approach align with?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Madhesh lies in which plains of Nepal?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Shah's assertive nationalism could harden Nepal's stance on which boundary dispute?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Revisiting that treaty could reduce India's traditional diplomatic ___ in Kathmandu. What word fills the blank?

Answer: _____

Q6.

As traditional parties decline, what must New Delhi rebuild beyond long-standing political channels? (two words)

Answer: _____

Background of Bilateral Ties: TITA practice

India and Canada are working to reset their relationship. During a visit to India, Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney signalled this reset, and cooperation between the two countries was described as widening across trade, energy and technology. The visit produced several outcomes in different sectors. Canada announced its intent to join the International Solar Alliance and was upgraded to full membership of the Global Biofuels Alliance. Both sides also signed a memorandum of understanding to build secure and resilient supply chains in critical minerals, an effort that aligns with the G7 Critical Minerals Action Plan. The minerals memorandum is one of the outcomes cited in the booklet. Canada will offer fully funded research internships to 300 Indian students each year. India remains the largest source of international students to Canada. The two countries also conduct joint research, which is part of the wider relationship. A technology and innovation partnership was launched to focus on emerging technologies, digital innovation and advanced manufacturing. In agriculture, a centre of excellence was established to work on fortified pulse products and food innovation. Many of these outcomes were announced during the same visit. Each outcome is linked to a specific sector, from solar energy to agriculture. Taken together, these outcomes cover energy, minerals, education, technology and agriculture.

Q1.

In which year were diplomatic ties between India and Canada established?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What was the value of bilateral trade between India and Canada in 2024, in billion US dollars?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which nuclear research reactor did Canada help India build? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Indian agency collaborates with the Canadian Space Agency? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year is the Nuclear Cooperation Agreement between India and Canada dated? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Besides oversight, the Nuclear Cooperation Agreement facilitates the supply of which material? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year did Canada assist India in building the CIRUS reactor? (year)

Answer: _____

Vienna Conventions and Diplomatic Immunity: TITA practice

Relations between India and Canada have been tested by a series of disputes in recent years. The booklet presents these disputes as major challenges in the relationship. One of them followed the killing of a Khalistani leader, after which allegations were made about a possible link with Indian agents. The disputes also raised questions about the rules that govern diplomats and their missions. Two international agreements set the framework for diplomatic and consular relations between nations. These agreements cover the status of diplomats, the premises of diplomatic missions and the work of consular officers. The conventions describe the protections that diplomats and consular officers receive, and the booklet summarises them as key provisions. Diplomatic ties between the two countries have deteriorated in this period. Economic ties have also been affected, and the rifts have created uncertainty about Canadian investment in India. Students and applicants are among those affected by these challenges, according to the booklet. Visa and immigration matters form one of these challenges. The booklet also notes that the disputes have been linked to the wider geopolitical context. Against this background, Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney signalled a reset with India during his visit, and the two sides moved to widen cooperation across trade, energy and technology.

Q1.

In which year is the Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations dated? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year is the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations dated? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What term describes the protection that shields diplomats from arrest? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What principle bars entry into diplomatic missions without permission? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Consular officers can perform their duties without what? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Besides expelling diplomats, what did both countries freeze in the dispute? (two words)

Answer: _____

Articles 1 to 4 at a Glance

The opening portion of the Constitution of India is concerned with the Union and its territory. It sets out the name of the country and the basic character of its government, even though the document gives the country a federal structure. The names of the States and Union Territories, along with the extent of their territory, are listed in a schedule to the Constitution, and the number of these units has changed over time. At the time of independence in 1947, the country was made up of British Provinces and Princely States. Legislation passed in 1947 had created two separate dominions, and the Princely States were given three choices: to join India, to join Pakistan, or to remain independent. Most of the Princely States joined India, although a few refused to do so at first. Those that stayed apart were later integrated by different means. The Constitution of 1950 then classified the States and territories into four groups. The same opening provisions allow Parliament to take up new States and changes to existing ones through laws it passes. Whether such laws must follow the procedure used for constitutional amendments is answered by the Constitution itself.

Q1.

Under which Part of the Constitution are the provisions on the Union and its territory placed? (Give the Part in Roman numerals.)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Under which Article is it stated that laws for admitting or establishing States are not amendments under Article 368?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under Article 2, establishment refers to States that were what before the law? (Give a short phrase.)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Article empowers Parliament to alter the boundaries of any State and change its name? (Give the number.)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Article sets out the amendment procedure from which laws under Articles 2 and 3 are excluded? (Give the number.)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which Article empowers Parliament to admit into the Union, or establish, new States? (Give the number.)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Article deals with the name of the country and the type of polity? (Give the number.)

Answer: _____

Dates of the Reorganisation Story

Demands for States organised on linguistic lines grew in several parts of the country after independence, and the government responded by setting up bodies to examine the question. Each of them examined the linguistic factor, but they did not reach the same conclusions. The creation of one State on a linguistic basis intensified demands from other regions, which pushed the

government to take up the whole question again. Reorganisation was therefore examined more than once before a final framework was adopted. The change was made through a law passed by Parliament and a constitutional amendment passed in the same year. Together these measures shaped the map of India as it stood after that year. The original Constitution divided the States and Territories into four categories. A three-member commission was appointed to re-examine the whole question, and its suggestions included abolishing those categories. Under the Constitution, Parliament holds the power to reorganise States, which can involve forming a new State by separating territory, merging States, altering boundaries, or changing the name of a State. Later changes, such as the renaming of Orissa as Odisha, show that the same power has continued to be used. The bodies examined the linguistic question at different points in time.

Q1.

In which month and year did the Fazl Ali Commission submit its report? (Give the month and year.)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which theory of State reorganisation did the Fazl Ali Commission reject? (Give a short phrase.)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was Andhra State created by separating Telugu-speaking areas from Madras State? (Give the year.)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which month and year was the Linguistic Provinces Commission under SK Dhar appointed? (Give the month and year.)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which month and year did the JVP Committee submit its report? (Give the month and year.)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which month and year did the Dhar Commission submit its report? (Give the month and year.)

Answer: _____

Early History of Caste-Based Reservation: TITA

The idea of caste-based reservation in India was first proposed in 1882, long before the present Constitution came into force. During British rule, elements of reservation took the form of separate electorates, a system in which members of a particular community chose their own representatives. This arrangement was not confined to a single group. Over time, the British applied separate electorates to several categories of people, and the arrangements were revised more than once.

After independence, the question of reservation was taken up within the new constitutional framework. The Constitution's guarantees of equality shaped how any special treatment could be provided, and courts were asked to examine whether particular measures were valid under them. Governments therefore had to fit their policies within these limits, and the judiciary had a decisive role in deciding where the limits lay.

Commissions were also set up to study the condition of backward classes, and their findings informed policy. Courts, in turn, ruled on reservation policies in several important cases, and those rulings set out conditions and ceilings that governments must observe when they design reservation schemes. The result is a system in which political choices and legal review have shaped

each other over the decades.

Q1.

In which year did the Government of India Act first give elements of reservation through separate electorates? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which agreement abandoned separate electorates for the Depressed Classes? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the MacDonald/Communal Award made that provided separate electorates for Depressed Classes? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the name of the first Backward Class Commission, set up in 1953? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did the Supreme Court decide MR Balaji v State of Mysore, ordering reservation to be kept at 50 per cent? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Government of India Act that extended separate electorates to Depressed Classes, Women and Labour passed? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which clause of Article 15 was added by the 1st Constitutional Amendment of 1951 to legalise caste-based reservation? (clause number)

Answer: _____

National Commission for Backward Classes: TITA

A permanent body for backward classes was first envisaged in a 1992 judgement on reservation. The judgement directed that a permanent statutory body should be set up to examine complaints of over-inclusion and under-inclusion in the list of backward classes, so that benefits reach those who need them. Errors in either direction, whether a community is wrongly included or wrongly left out, were what the direction aimed to address. The aim was to keep the list accurate so that the reservation system works as intended.

The second Backward Classes Commission is one example of the inquiries that preceded this idea. It was appointed to study the conditions of socially and educationally backward classes and to suggest measures for their advancement, and its work dealt with the same underlying question of who needs support.

The national body that was eventually created came through an Act of Parliament. Its work concerns the welfare of backward classes and the examination of matters that affect them. Because it operates within the wider framework of reservation, its findings bear on the economic criteria that decide who is excluded from benefits, and on how reservation is shared among groups. Its role is therefore closely tied to the working of reservation as a whole.

Q1.

In which year was the National Commission for Backward Classes set up by an Act of Parliament? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Who chaired the second Backward Classes Commission? (surname)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the 102nd Constitutional Amendment Act passed? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under which Article did the Constitution empower the President to specify socially and educationally backward classes in States and UTs? (article number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the Kalelkar Commission set up? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which Constitutional Amendment of 2019 provided 10 per cent reservation for EWS? (amendment number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was the 1st Constitutional Amendment passed? (year)

Answer: _____

Penal and Council Provisions: TITA

The Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019 was enacted after the Supreme Court's judgment in NALSA vs Union of India recognised transgender people as a third gender and granted them legal recognition and rights. The 2019 Act was passed to provide protection of rights of transgender persons and their welfare. The government has now presented the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Amendment Bill, 2026 in the Lok Sabha to revise that Act. The Bill narrows the definition of transgender person and removes some categories, including trans-man, trans-woman and genderqueer. The penal provisions are also expanded, and they now cover forced mutilation of minors, along with other offences. The Bill requires medical institutions to report gender-affirming surgeries to an authority. Under the Bill, certificate holders are allowed to change their name in documents. The Bill also revises the composition of the National Council for Transgender Persons. Supporters and critics have both commented on the Bill, with critics pointing to the earlier Supreme Court judgment and supporters pointing to the aim of welfare. Some critics also say that the broad wording of the Bill could affect organisations that work with transgender persons. The sections of the Bill discussed in this passage cover penal, reporting and council changes.

Q1.

What punishment does the Bill prescribe for forced mutilation of minors? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Under the Bill, up to how many years of imprisonment can be imposed for forcing children into begging? (number of years)

Answer: _____

Q3.

To which authority must medical institutions report gender-affirming surgeries? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Who nominates the members of the National Council for Transgender Persons under the Bill? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What term describes representation that moves across regions in turn? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

The National Council must include representatives of which two kinds of territorial units? (answer in short form)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In what kind of documents can certificate holders change their name? (one word)

Answer: _____

Significance and Criticism: TITA

The Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Amendment Bill, 2026 has drawn both support and criticism. Supporters say the Bill aims to make welfare more targeted, and they point out that a narrower definition can help focus benefits. They also say that certification based on verification reduces the discretionary power of District Magistrates. According to supporters, mandatory reporting can help build a national record for planning healthcare and welfare schemes. They also note that the penal framework addresses serious crimes. Critics say that the Bill departs from an earlier Supreme Court judgment, which recognised rights for transgender persons. Critics also argue that the verification process raises concerns about how transgender people are assessed. They raise concerns about the reporting of certain procedures, and they warn that broad language in the Bill could be used against groups working in the sector. Such language, critics say, may also restrict support that people give voluntarily to those seeking transition-related help. The Bill also removes some categories from the definition of transgender person, and it changes the way such persons obtain certificates. The debate covers several parts of the Bill, including its penal, certification and reporting provisions. The Bill proposes changes to several parts of the law.

Q1.

In which year did the NALSA vs Union of India judgment come? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which term, listed alongside 'Allurement', is described as a broad term that could be misused? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

According to critics, verification may do what to a person's gender? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Mandatory reporting of surgeries may violate which kind of confidentiality? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

The penal framework addresses mutilation, abduction and forced _____. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

The narrower definition aims to ensure that benefits reach which kind of communities? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under which Article of the Constitution did the NALSA judgment recognise a Fundamental Right for transgender persons? (number)

Answer: _____

Revised Figures and Their Uses

A revision of the national accounts can change many figures at once. The new series for the year 2025-26 is released with a revised base, and the change affects how the economy looks compared with earlier estimates. The economy has changed in structure, with digital services expansion, renewable energy growth and changing consumption patterns. A periodic revision is meant to reflect these shifts in the data. The new series also integrates high-frequency datasets, including GST collections and vehicle registration data, which add to the coverage of the informal sector, gig economy and household enterprise activity. Government sector accounting has been improved, and the estimates of government finances are now more accurate. Better economic data is expected to help policy formulation, investment and business planning. The revision is therefore presented as an improvement in statistical reliability for the country. Improved methodologies and granular data enhance the accuracy of the economic growth rate. The base year 2022-23 was chosen as the most recent normal economic year after the COVID-19 disruptions. The series is aligned with the System of National Accounts 2008.

Q1.

What is the revised real GDP growth rate for FY 2025-26? (give the number, in %)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the revised nominal GDP for FY 2025-26? (give the number, in lakh crore)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the revised fiscal deficit as a percentage of GDP? (give the number, in %)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What was the earlier target for the debt-to-GDP ratio for FY 2026-27? (give the number, in %)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which sector's growth in FY 2025-26 was 2.8%? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which sector grew by 9.5% in FY 2025-26? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What was tertiary sector growth in FY 2024-25? (give the number, in %)

Answer: _____

India and BRICS: Typed Answer Practice

The World Happiness Report is an annual ranking of countries based on how people evaluate their own lives. Respondents are asked to rate their lives on a numbered scale, and the results are read together with six key indicators. These indicators are GDP per capita, social support, healthy life expectancy, freedom, generosity and perception of corruption. Because the report looks at these factors together, it helps countries assess development beyond GDP alone.

The report does not compare countries only on one global list. It also places countries within regional and economic groups, so that a country can be seen against its neighbours and against the other members of BRICS. India is one of the countries studied in South Asia, and its position can be read alongside the positions of its neighbours. Such comparisons show how a country stands relative to others in its own group.

India's place in the 2026 edition can also be compared with its earlier position, because rankings can move from one edition to the next. A change in rank is shown alongside the country's score, so the movement and the level of well-being can be read together. Areas where a country has improved are also identified in the report.

The 2026 report was released on International Day of Happiness, which is observed every year on 20 March. The report emphasises well-being as a policy goal.

Q1.

Which BRICS nation ranked highest in the 2026 World Happiness Report? (country)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which BRICS nation was placed 97th in the 2026 World Happiness Report? (country)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What overall rank did Russia hold in the 2026 World Happiness Report? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

India's position in the 2026 report improved from which earlier rank? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which South Asian country was placed 99th in the 2026 World Happiness Report? (country)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which country was placed 134th in the 2026 World Happiness Report? (country)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which country was placed 104th in the 2026 World Happiness Report? (country)

Answer: _____

Social Media and Youth: Typed Answer Practice

The 2026 World Happiness Report examines how social media use relates to happiness among young people. The report looks at life satisfaction across age groups, comparing how people in different age brackets rate their lives. It also considers how much time young people spend on these platforms, rather than treating all use as the same. The study is therefore about patterns of use as well as the simple fact of using these platforms. Life satisfaction in the report is measured through people's own ratings of their lives, which allows the results to be compared across groups and countries. The findings are presented as a set of key insights. Some of these insights concern developing countries, where the effects of digital tools are discussed separately. The report also describes situations in which the same tools bring strain. Its findings suggest that the amount of use matters, since some levels of use are associated with lower well-being than others. Taken together, these insights help show how young people are faring in a digital environment. The report was released on International Day of Happiness, and it is part of the annual series published under the World Happiness Report name.

Q1.

Adolescent girls using social media for more than how many hours a day form the most vulnerable group? (hours)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In how many countries was the age-based youth life satisfaction pattern observed, according to the report? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Youth in which age bracket reported lower life satisfaction than people aged 60 and above? (age range)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In developing countries like India, digital access improves education and what other area? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In developing countries like India, excessive digital use causes stress and what? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Heavy social media use is linked with a decline in which area of health? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which country is named alongside Canada, Australia and New Zealand for the youth life satisfaction pattern? (country)

Answer: _____

India's Arms Import Sources

The Stockholm International Peace Research Institute, known as SIPRI, is an independent international research institute. It has its headquarters in Stockholm, Sweden. Its focus areas include conflict and peace studies, armaments and military expenditure, arms transfers and disarmament. The institute released a report titled Trends in International Arms Transfers 2025, which analyses global defence trade patterns. The report covers international arms transfers during the 2021-25 period and compares them with the 2016-20 period. Among its key global findings, international arms transfers increased over the comparison period, while arms imports by European countries rose sharply, a rise the report largely links to the Russia-Ukraine war. The report also records that arms exports from Russia declined, reducing its share of global exports. The United States is shown as the top exporter, followed by France, Russia, Germany and China. The findings are presented as a set of key global findings, followed by specific findings for India. India is discussed as one of the major importers in the report, and its arms imports are examined for the 2021-25 period. The analysis covers the countries that supply India and the trends in its overall import volumes. Taken together, the report provides a broad view of how weapons move between countries, and it places India within this wider pattern of global defence trade.

Q1.

What percentage of India's arms imports during 2021-25 came from Russia? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What percentage of India's arms imports during 2021-25 came from France? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which country supplied 15% of India's arms imports during 2021-25?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was SIPRI established?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What percentage share did Russia hold in global arms exports after its decline, as per the SIPRI report? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q6.

By what percentage did arms imports by European countries rise, according to the SIPRI report? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What percentage share of global arms exports did the United States hold, as per the SIPRI report? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

India's Defence Self-Reliance Push

India has several government initiatives in its defence sector, which the report describes under the heading of efforts to reduce arms imports. The government has announced a defence budget for the 2026-27 year, and the report records the value of defence production and exports for the year 2024-25. Targets have also been set for production and exports for the year 2029. The rules for foreign investment in defence are structured in two parts, one for investment through the automatic route and another through the government route. Innovation in the sector is also an area of focus under the government programmes. The top three destinations for Indian defence exports are named in the report. The report sets out these figures as part of the country efforts to build its defence capacity, and the initiatives are presented together so that production, exports, investment and innovation can be read as one set of measures. Together, these measures show how the country is trying to expand its own capacity to produce defence equipment while reducing its reliance on arms bought from other countries.

Q1.

What is India's defence production target for 2029? (in Rs lakh crore)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What was the value of India's defence exports in 2024-25? (in Rs crore)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the defence budget allocation for 2026-27? (in Rs lakh crore)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What does the acronym iDEX stand for?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What percentage of FDI is permitted through the automatic route in defence? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which state, other than Uttar Pradesh, has a Defence Industrial Corridor?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which country, besides the US and France, is among the top three defence export destinations?

Answer: _____

Olympic History: Dates and Names

Olympic history begins in ancient Greece, where the first Games were held at Olympia. The history books hold a record of the last ancient Games, which shows when that tradition ended. Later, a ruler issued an order that banned the Games together with Greek temples and statues of gods, as part of a wider effort to promote Christianity.

The modern movement was launched much later. A founder led its revival, and an international committee was set up to organise it. The first modern international event took place in a Greek city, after a royal announcement that the Games would begin again. Today the committee is headquartered in Switzerland.

India first took part in the Olympics in an early edition, and it first sent a team to the Summer Games at a later date. Indian athletes have also competed at a Winter Games held in Austria. Some

editions were cancelled during world wars, and the Olympics scheduled for 2020 were moved to a later year because of COVID-19 restrictions. Italy has hosted the Olympic Games on several occasions, including the Winter Games in Cortina in 1956, and Rome hosted the Summer Games in 1960.

Q1.

In which year (with era) did the ancient Olympic Games begin at Olympia? (year with BCE/AD)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year (AD) was the order banning the Olympics, along with Greek temples and statues of gods, issued? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Who is credited as the founder of the modern Olympic Games? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which Greek city was the first modern international Olympic event held? (city)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the International Olympic Committee established? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

To which year were the 2020 Olympics postponed because of COVID-19 restrictions? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year did India first participate in the Olympic Games? (year)

Answer: _____

India's Sports Schemes: Names and Years

The motto of the Olympic movement, Citius, Altius, Fortius, is a reminder of the values that drive athletes. India's sporting system includes programmes that work at several levels. Khelo India focuses on identifying and developing athletes at grassroots and elite levels, and the Khelo India Youth Games and Para Games were hosted in Bihar in 2025. The Khelo India Winter Games were planned for Ladakh and Jammu & Kashmir.

The national sports policy aims to enhance the quality of sports training, promote participation, and increase the number of athletes competing internationally. A government ministry acts as the nodal body for sports, and a cell within that structure supports athletes who are preparing for the Olympics.

Doping remains a serious concern. A 2023 report from the World Anti-Doping Agency found that India had the highest positivity rate for banned substances among major nations. In track and field, the Athletics Integrity Unit also recorded doping offences involving Indian athletes. India has also competed at the Winter Games, including an appearance in Austria. The Olympic Games in 2026 were held in cities across Italy, namely Milan and Cortina d'Ampezzo.

Q1.

In which year was the Indian Olympic Association set up? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Who is the President of the Indian Olympic Association? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which city is the headquarters of the Indian Olympic Association located? (city)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the Target Olympic Podium Scheme launched? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Indian initiative launched in 2019 encourages mass participation in fitness activities? (name of initiative)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which city is the headquarters of the International Olympic Committee located? (city)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was the KIRTI Programme launched for school children aged 9 to 18? (year)

Answer: _____

Global Strategy and Partners: TITA

Every year, the world marks one day to focus attention on tuberculosis, a disease that has affected people for generations. The occasion is used to raise awareness and to speed up global efforts. A central reference point for these efforts is the End TB Strategy of the World Health Organization. Its goals concern the number of deaths from the disease and the number of new cases each year, and it includes milestones that allow progress to be checked. Alongside national governments, several international partner organisations also work on the disease. They support countries in their programmes and help build the capacity needed to carry those programmes out. In India, several initiatives were launched recently, and they have been described as tools for monitoring the disease and encouraging citizens to take part. Taken together, these efforts show how the response to tuberculosis is organised across many levels, from national programmes to global partnerships. Progress depends on governments, health workers and communities working together over a long period.

Q1.

In which year does the WHO End TB Strategy period end? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

By which year are the WHO End TB Strategy's targets for TB deaths and incidence set? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Who discovered the TB bacterium in 1882? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did the WHO End TB Strategy begin? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What percentage reduction in TB incidence does the WHO End TB Strategy target by 2030? (number, in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the TB bacterium discovered? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What kind of systems do the Global Fund and Stop TB Partnership strengthen? (one word)

Answer: _____

Disease and Drug Resistance: TITA

Tuberculosis is a long-standing health problem that many countries still struggle with. Its cause is a microscopic germ, and the infection can move from one person to another under the right conditions. Medical reports describe the disease in separate categories, depending on which part of the body it attacks. Patients are usually treated with a set of medicines, and the first medicines used are chosen from a known group. When the infection does not respond to those medicines, the case becomes much harder to manage. Such cases have been described by health authorities as a serious concern for public health. The disease can be prevented and controlled, and timely diagnosis matters a great deal. Health workers play a part in finding cases early, and governments follow the course of the disease closely. Treatment has to be completed as prescribed, and every stage of care depends on accurate testing and steady cooperation among doctors, patients and institutions. A day of observance is held each year to raise awareness, and the response to the disease has been organised through national programmes and a wider global strategy. In India, several initiatives have been launched to monitor the disease and to encourage citizens to take part in its elimination.

Q1.

Which genus of bacteria causes tuberculosis? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Name the first-line TB drug that is not Ethambutol, Rifampicin or Isoniazid. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Along with Isoniazid, which first-line drug is MDR-TB resistant to? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

MDR-TB requires which class of drugs for treatment, in place of standard first-line drugs? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which form of TB affects organs outside the lungs? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

MDR-TB is described as a threat to which global concept? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Through which route does TB spread between people? (one word)

Answer: _____

Diplomacy and the Islet Dispute

India's diplomacy in early 2026 combined high-level visits with agreements on trade, technology and workforce mobility. The President of Brazil made a state visit to India, and the two countries adopted a joint declaration on digital partnership covering digital infrastructure, artificial intelligence and emerging technologies. The visit was accompanied by several sector agreements. Brazil's President also received an invitation to the BRICS 2026 Summit in India. Their strategic partnership dates back to 2006, and the two sides also discussed critical minerals, defence and food security. Ties with Israel were upgraded to a special strategic partnership, with new cooperation in cybersecurity, semiconductors and space technology. The Israel arrangements also addressed labour mobility over the coming years. In Europe, India and Finland agreed to elevate their relationship in digitalisation and sustainability during a visit linked to the Raisina Dialogue, a forum launched in 2016. Japan and South Korea continue to dispute a pair of islets that Japan calls Takeshima and South Korea calls Dokdo. The dispute is rooted in Japan's colonial rule over Korea, and the islets were not explicitly named in a 1951 peace treaty. Both countries describe the islets with names that reflect their sovereignty claims, which makes the matter politically sensitive. South Korea has protested a Japanese government-backed event held in Shimane Prefecture.

Q1.

Who was the Chief Guest at the 11th Raisina Dialogue held in New Delhi in 2026?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In 2025, bilateral trade between India and Brazil reached how many US\$ billion?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What percentage of global niobium reserves does Brazil hold?

Answer: _____

Q4.

The validity of multiple-entry tourist and business visas was extended from 5 years to how many years?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Indian firm will set up an E175 jet assembly line with Embraer?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Israel will allow up to how many Indian workers over the next 5 years?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Brazilian city hosted COP30?

Answer: _____

Vaccination, Water and Biodiversity

India's public health and water programmes have been revised to focus on regular delivery and sustained coverage. The Universal Immunisation Programme was re-launched in 1985 and offers free vaccines to infants and pregnant women against several vaccine-preventable diseases. Intensified drives have targeted districts where coverage is 70% or below, and a later drive reached children who missed doses during the Covid-19 pandemic. Mission Indradhanush aims to give full immunisation to children up to two years of age, and it is supported by a digital platform. Water policy has moved in a similar direction. The Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 extends work to December 2028, with its focus on citizen-centric service delivery rather than infrastructure alone. Under the Jal Arpan initiative, completed water infrastructure is handed over through a formal protocol involving Gram Panchayats. India's biodiversity commitments run alongside this, and the Convention on Biological Diversity requires member countries to submit periodic reports on the measures they take. India has also submitted its first national report under the Nagoya Protocol, which covers access and benefit-sharing mechanisms. The reports highlight progress in conservation, sustainable resource use and fair sharing of benefits from biological resources. Monetary and non-monetary benefits both count under this framework. Such progress is reported at regular intervals.

Q1.

In which year was Intensified Mission Indradhanush 1.0 launched?

Answer: _____

Q2.

On which day of March is National Vaccination Day observed?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was India certified polio-free?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What are the Village Water Committees also called in the Jal Arpan handover protocol?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the water supply standard, in litres per capita per day, under the Jal Jeevan Mission?

Answer: _____

Q6.

What digital platform is used to map drinking water infrastructure?

Answer: _____

Q7.

How many years is the generally followed cycle for India's national reports under the Convention on Biological Diversity?

Answer: _____

Forex, Fiscal Index and NavIC

Several economic and strategic developments in early 2026 reflected pressures in global markets and regional security. India's foreign exchange reserves declined by a notable amount, as the central bank supported the rupee and rising crude oil prices added to demand for dollars. The Reserve Bank of India manages these reserves, which consist of foreign currency assets, gold, special drawing rights and a reserve tranche position with the International Monetary Fund. An international framework on investment facilitation was discussed at the World Trade Organization,

and India did not support it. In the same period, NITI Aayog released the Fiscal Health Index, an annual evaluation of states that relies on audited data from the Comptroller and Auditor General. On security, the government's counter-terrorism policy set out a zero-tolerance doctrine. Meanwhile, an airfield in eastern Ladakh drew attention for its high altitude and its proximity to the border. Satellite navigation was also in focus after an atomic clock failure affected a regional navigation system called NavIC, which is developed by ISRO and needs several satellites to work reliably. India's reserve tranche position is a quota-based reserve with the IMF. The reserves are used to stabilise the rupee, finance imports, cushion external shocks and enhance economic credibility.

Q1.

By how many US\$ billion did India's forex reserves drop in the reported period?

Answer: _____

Q2.

For which financial year does the Fiscal Health Index 2026 evaluate states? Give the answer in the format YYYY-YY.

Answer: _____

Q3.

The Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement was launched in 2017 at which ministerial conference?

Answer: _____

Q4.

NavIC stands for Navigation with what? Give the two words that complete the expansion.

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many satellites form the NavIC constellation?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which region of eastern Ladakh is Mudh-Nyoma Air Force Station situated?

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the elevation of Mudh-Nyoma Air Force Station, in feet?

Answer: _____

BAFTA Awards: short-answer practice

The British Academy of Film and Television Arts is the organisation that presents the BAFTA awards. Its honours cover film and television work, and the booklet entry on the subject is set out as a short reference rather than as a long article. The entry deals with a recent ceremony and with a set of earlier milestones connected with Indian work. The subject is part of the Miscellaneous section of the booklet.

The recent ceremony is the 2026 edition. Its results are listed by category, and the top film prize, the director's award and the lead acting awards are among the honours shown. The booklet records each winner's name against the honour, so a reader can check the result for every category shown.

The milestones are recorded in separate points. One point describes a film from India that won a children's and family honour at the awards, and it names the director and the producers. Another

point describes the first Indian performer to take a competitive acting honour, and it names the film for which the award was given.

A further point covers a British film honour given in an earlier year, and another covers an award for film music. The page also carries the publisher's website and the page numbers.

Q1.

In which year was BAFTA established? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which film won Best Film at the 2026 BAFTA Awards? (title)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Who won Best Leading Actress at the 2026 BAFTA Awards for Hamnet? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Manipuri film became the first Indian film to win Best Children's and Family Film at the 2026 BAFTA Awards? (title)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Who directed the Manipuri film Boong? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which film did Rohini Hattangadi win the Best Supporting Actress award at BAFTA? (film)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which film earned A.R. Rahman a BAFTA for Best Film Music? (title)

Answer: _____

ASMITA Initiative: short-answer practice

ASMITA is an initiative connected with sport, and the booklet includes it under the Miscellaneous heading of the March 2026 Current Affairs material. The name is built from letters, and each letter stands for a word in a longer phrase. The phrase is written in English and describes the goals of the initiative in general terms. The initiative is presented in the booklet as a single entry.

The entry is short and uses a fixed set of headings. The headings deal with the start of the initiative, the body responsible for it, the name it used before its current name, and the goals it sets out. Each heading is treated as one point in the entry.

The goals are described in two parts. The first part concerns the level at which the initiative works, and the second concerns the group of players it looks to find. Both parts appear together in the entry, so the aims can be read in one place.

The entry sits alongside other items in the same section of the booklet. Those items include award-related entries, and the section as a whole covers a mix of topics under the Miscellaneous heading. The entry appears on the same page as the Oscars material.

Q1.

In which year was ASMITA launched? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which ministry launched ASMITA? (name of ministry)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What was ASMITA earlier known as? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What does the letter 'M' in ASMITA stand for? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Talent is to be sought especially from which two kinds of areas? (two adjectives)

Answer: _____

Q6.

At which level does ASMITA promote sports participation among girls and women? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What does the letter 'I' in ASMITA stand for? (one word)

Answer: _____

Schemes and Electoral Options: Short Answer Practice

One of them gives voters a formal way to reject every candidate standing in an election while still taking part in democratic life. Its stated purpose is to let citizens express dissatisfaction and to strengthen voter freedom. Another initiative is a rooftop solar scheme launched in 2024, which is described as the world's largest domestic rooftop solar initiative. Its objective is to install rooftop systems in one crore households, and participants receive free electricity up to a monthly limit. The scheme's subsidy covers a share of the installation cost, and it runs till FY 2026-27. A third initiative is the Sujal Gaon ID, launched by the Ministry of Jal Shakti. It assigns a unique, scheme-based digital identifier to every rural piped drinking water supply scheme, creating a digital record that supports governance and monitoring. Finally, the Namo Bharat system is a rail-based commuter service built for travel within the National Capital Region. It is a semi-high speed system, and its implementing agency is a joint venture of several governments. The round-up gives each entry its own heading and short summary. Each entry is short, and the items are listed one after another within the section.

Q1.

Which Supreme Court case introduced NOTA in India? (case name with year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the maximum speed of the Namo Bharat RRTS, in km/h? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which ministry is the nodal ministry for the PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Each Sujal Gaon ID is linked to which other ID? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Up to what percentage of the installation cost is the rooftop solar subsidy? (number, in %)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which corporation implements the Nam0 Bharat RRTS? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q7.

How many units of free electricity per month does the rooftop solar scheme provide? (number of units)

Answer: _____

Trade and Energy Items: Short Answer Practice

The March 2026 round-up's trade and energy entries cover several related topics. One concerns a principle that governs trade among WTO members, which the round-up describes in some detail. A second concerns an agreement between India and the European Union on trade in services. A third concerns a refinery project in the United States that has been described as a large investment. The fourth entry is about a crude oil that is produced in several countries and has a high hydrogen-to-carbon ratio. The crude is described as low-density and is trapped within low-permeability shale or tight sandstone formations. The refinery is described as a major new oil refinery constructed in the USA, and the refinery entry names a major Indian firm as a partner. The round-up also lists where the crude oil is produced, which allows readers to see its global reach. Each of these topics is written as a separate entry, and each entry has a title and a short paragraph of text. The round-up presents the services agreement as a separate item from the refinery and the crude oil entry. Readers can compare these entries with the other items in the same section of the update.

Q1.

Which Indian company was announced as a key partner in the \$300 billion Texas Oil Refinery Project? (company name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which company developed the Texas refinery project? (name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which trade principle requires a country to treat all WTO members equally in trade concessions? (name or abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q4.

For how many years did India and the EU agree to grant MFN status in trade in services? (number of years)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which region of the USA is described as its largest oil-producing region? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

At which port in South Texas is the refinery located? (name of port)

Answer: _____

Sports and Border Trade: Short Answer Practice

The sports entry in the March 2026 round-up concerns a first-ever event for tribal communities. The event is planned for 2026 under a national sports scheme whose purpose is to strengthen India's sports ecosystem. It aims to bring tribal sporting talent into the national system while keeping traditional indigenous games alive. The round-up lists the sports involved and notes that several national bodies share responsibility for organising the event. A mascot has been chosen to represent the pride, bravery and cultural identity of tribal communities. The second entry concerns a Himalayan pass in the Uttarakhand region. The round-up describes it as the first Indian border post for trade with a neighbouring country. Trade through the pass was paused during a pandemic and is set to resume. The pass is also used on a yatra route, and an alternate route through Nathu La Pass is mentioned, while a route through Dharchula is under repair. The round-up presents both items as news from March 2026, and each has its own short paragraph and key points. Readers are given the names of the bodies and the purpose of each initiative in the entries.

Q1.

What is the name of the mascot of the Khelo India Tribal Games? (name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which ministry launched the Khelo India Scheme? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which Indian state is the first Khelo India Tribal Games set to be hosted in 2026? (state name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which region of Uttarakhand is Lipulekh Pass located? (region name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

After how many years of COVID-induced suspension is India set to resume border trade via Lipulekh Pass? (number of years)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Lipulekh Pass is a tri-junction of India, Nepal and which third country? (country name)

Answer: _____